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Daily Lessons with Simon, ex-IELTS examiner

前雅思考官 Simon 的每日课程

IELTS Academic Writing Task 2

雅思学术类写作任务 2

- In the second part of the IELTS Academic Writing Test, you have to write 250 words. 在雅思学术类写作测试的第二部分，你必须写 250 个单词。
- You should spend 40 minutes on this task. 你应该在这个任务上花费 40 分钟。
- Writing Task 2 is worth more than Task 1, so you need to do it well. 写作任务 2 的分值高于任务 1，所以你需要把它做好。
- For IELTS Writing Task 2, you have to write an essay discussing a topic. 对于雅思写作任务 2，你必须写一篇短文讨论一个话题。
- You will be given an opinion/ argument, different points of view or a problem to discuss. 你将被给予一个观点/论点、不同的视角或一个需要讨论的问题。
- Most students prepare phrases for introducing and linking ideas. 大多数学生会准备用于引入和连接观点的短语。
- However, not many students prepare good ideas and opinions for IELTS topics. 然而，没有多少学生会针对雅思考题准备良好的观点和意见。
- We'll work on these areas: 我们将专注于以下领域：
 - How to structure a good Task 2 essay. 如何构建一篇优秀的任务 2 短文。
 - Preparation of ideas, opinions and good vocabulary for each IELTS topic. 针对每个雅思话题准备观点、意见和优质词汇。
 - How to build and link sentences to create coherent paragraphs. 如何构建和衔接句子以创建连贯的段落。
 - Common mistakes in grammar and word usage. 语法和词汇使用中的常见错误。
- Some hard work on these areas can make a big difference to your writing score. 在这些领域付出努力可以大幅提升你的写作分数。

IELTS Writing Task 2: another example

雅思写作任务 2：另一个示例

- Here's another example of a "firstly, secondly, finally" paragraph that I wrote with my students: 这是我和学生们一起写的关于“首先，其次，最后”段落的另一个示例：
 1. Firstly, Secondly, Finally
 2. 首先，其次，最后

- 1. One problem is that, Urban areas also tend to, Other drawbacks are that
2. 一个问题是，城市地区往往也会，其他缺点是
- 1. The main disadvantage is that, Another issue is that, Also,
2. 主要缺点是，另一个问题是，此外，
- Three main factors are affecting health in modern societies. 三个主要因素正在影响现代社会的人们健康。
- One problem is the lack of awareness among many people of the negative consequences of an unhealthy diet. 一个问题是许多人缺乏对不健康饮食负面后果的认识。
- This is made worse by the prevalence of fast food and processed food, which are full of fat, salt and sugar. 快餐和加工食品的普及使情况进一步恶化，这些食品富含脂肪、盐和糖。
- Another key factor is the changing trend in lifestyles. 另一个关键因素是生活方式的变化趋势。
- For example, children's hobbies now involve much less outdoor activity, and adults are less active as jobs have shifted towards sedentary office work instead of manual labour. 例如，现在孩子的爱好包含的户外活动少得多，而随着工作从体力劳动转向久坐不动的办公室工作，成年人的活动量也减少了。
- In addition to this, time-saving technologies, such as cars, elevators, dishwashers and washing machines, have made people lazier. 除此之外，汽车、电梯、洗碗机和洗衣机等省时技术让人类变得更加懒惰。
- Analyse the paragraph by answering the following questions. 通过回答以下问题来分析该段落。
 - 1. What is the main topic of the paragraph?
2. 该段落的主题是什么？
 - 1. Which phrases are used instead of "firstly, secondly, finally"?
2. 使用了哪些短语来替代“首先，其次，最后”？
 - 1. What examples of 'band 7-9' vocabulary can you find?
2. 你能找到哪些“7-9分”词汇的例子？

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'while' introductions

雅思写作任务 2: 'while' 引导的开头段

- If you want to mention both sides of the argument for an "agree or disagree" question, try including a 'while' sentence in your introduction. 如果你想在“同意或不同意”类题目中提及论点的双方，可以尝试在开头段中包含一个由 'while' 引导的句子。
- Here's the 'while' sentence formula: "While I accept argument A, I favour argument B" 以下是 'while' 句型的公式：“虽然我接受观点 A，但我更倾向于观点 B”
- Here's an example question: 以下是一个题目示例：
- Early technological developments helped ordinary people and changed their lives more than recent developments. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 早期技术的发展比近期的发展对普通人的帮助更大，也更改变了他们的生活。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？
- Here's my introduction: 以下是我的开头段：

- Technological progress has taken place throughout the course of human history. 技术进步贯穿了人类历史的全过程。
- While early technologies certainly changed the lives of normal people, I believe that recent breakthroughs have had an even greater impact. 虽然早期技术确实改变了普通人的生活，但我认为近期的突破产生了更大的影响。
- Note: The 'while' sentence makes it clear that I favour one side of the argument, but it allows me to mention both sides in the main body of my essay. 注意：'while' 句型明确了我倾向于论点的一方，但它允许我在文章正文中提及双方。

IELTS Writing Task 2: strong or balanced opinion

雅思写作任务 2：强烈的观点或中立平衡的观点

- The following question asks for your opinion. 以下问题询问你的观点。
- You can either have a strong opinion or a more balanced opinion, but you should definitely make your opinion clear in your introduction. 你可以拥有强烈的观点，也可以拥有更平衡的观点，但你绝对应该在开头段明确表达你的观点。
- Governments should not have to provide care or financial support for elderly people because it is the responsibility of each person to prepare for retirement and support him or herself. To what extent do you agree or disagree with this opinion? 政府不应该为老年人提供照顾或财政支持，因为每个人都有责任为退休做准备并自食其力。你在多大程度上同意或不同意这一观点？
- Introduction (strong opinion): 开头段（强烈观点）：
- People have different views about whether or not governments should help senior citizens. 关于政府是否应该帮助老年人，人们有不同的看法。
- I completely disagree with the idea that elderly people should receive no support from the state. 我完全不同意老年人不应获得国家任何支持的观点。
- Introduction (more balanced opinion): 开头段（更平衡的观点）：
- People have different views about whether or not governments should help senior citizens. 关于政府是否应该帮助老年人，人们有不同的看法。
- Although I accept that we all have a responsibility to save money for retirement, I disagree with the idea that elderly people should receive no support from the state. 虽然我接受我们所有人都有责任为退休攒钱，但我不同意老年人不应获得国家任何支持的观点。
- Note: After the first introduction, I'd advise you to write 2 paragraphs that both explain why you disagree. 注意：在第一个开头段之后，我建议你写两段正文，均解释你为什么不同意。
- The second introduction allows you to discuss both sides (which might be easier). 第二个开头段则允许你讨论双方（这可能会更容易一些）。

IELTS Writing Task 2: short, clear introduction

雅思写作任务 2：简短清晰的开头段

- My colleague, Peter, wrote an essay about last week's credit card question - to read the full essay, look for the comment by Peter Walton below the lesson. 我的同事 Peter 写了一篇关于上周信用卡问题的文章——要阅读全文，请在课程下方查找 Peter Walton 的评论。
- For today, I want to focus on the introduction that Peter wrote: 今天，我想专注于 Peter 所写的开头段：
- It is all too easy to obtain a credit card and then to run up debts which are difficult to repay. 获得信用卡然后欠下难以偿还的债务实在是太容易了。
- In my opinion, the disadvantages of credit cards far outweigh the advantages. 在我看来，信用卡的缺点远大于优点。
- It might seem easy, but for me this is the perfect introduction: it's short, clear, and it answers the question directly. 这看似简单，但对我来说这是完美的开头段：简短、清晰，并且直接回答了问题。

IELTS Writing Task 2: really short conclusion!

雅思写作任务 2：极其简短的结尾段！

- It's fine to write a really short conclusion for IELTS writing task 2. 在雅思写作任务 2 中写一个极其简短的结尾段是可以的。
- You don't need to say anything new; just paraphrase what you wrote in your introduction or summarise your overall answer to the question. 你不需要阐述任何新内容；只需改写你在开头段写过的内容，或总结你对问题的整体回答即可。
- For example, read last week's question and my introduction, then read my short conclusion below. 例如，阅读上周的题目和我的开头段，然后阅读我下面的简短结尾段。
- In conclusion, I disagree with the idea that early technologies had more of an effect on ordinary people than recent ones. 总之，我不同意早期技术比近期技术对普通人影响更大的观点。

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'perfect society' paragraph

雅思写作任务 2：“完美社会”段落

- Last week I made a video lesson to show you how I would do an essay plan. 上周我制作了一个视频课程，向你们展示我会如何做文章规划。
- Today I want to show you how I turned part of that plan into a full paragraph. 今天我想向你们展示我是如何将该计划的一部分变成一个完整的段落的。
 - Paragraph topic: The most important element of a perfect society. 段落主题：完美社会最重要的要素。
 - Planned ideas: Safety = No crime, trust our neighbours, feel part of a community, able to leave doors unlocked. Trust institutions (police, government), feel protected by the law. Safety is the most basic freedom. 规划的观点：安全 = 没有犯罪，信任邻居，感觉自己是社区的一部分，能够夜不闭户。信任机构（警察、政府），感觉受到法律保护。安全是最基本的自由。
- Here's my paragraph using the ideas above: 以下是利用上述观点写的段落：
- If I had to choose the one, most desirable element of an ideal society, it would have to be safety. 如果让

我选择理想社会中最渴望拥有的一个要素，那必然是安全。

- A safe society would be one in which crime did not exist, and in which all citizens trusted their neighbours, felt part of a community, and were even able to leave their doors unlocked without fear. 一个安全的社会是一个不存在犯罪的社会，在这个社会里，所有公民都信任他们的邻居，感觉自己是社区的一部分，甚至能够毫无顾虑地夜不闭户。
- A broader definition of safety could also include belief in the integrity of state institutions, such as governments or police forces, and confidence that we are all protected by fair laws. 更广泛的安全定义还可以包括对政府或警察部队等国家机构公信力的信仰，以及对我们大家都受到公正法律保护的信心。
- In this sense, safety could be described as the most basic freedom and the starting point for the creation of a perfect society. 从这个意义上说，安全可以说是最基本的自由，也是构建完美社会的起点。

IELTS Writing Task 2: consumer society

雅思写作任务 2：消费型社会

- A few days ago, I looked at the question in this lesson with my students here in Manchester. 几天前，我和曼彻斯特的学生们一起探讨了本课中的这个题目。
- The phrase 'consumer society' is a negative one because it suggests that our lives revolve around money and possessions. “消费型社会”这一短语带有贬义色彩，因为它暗示我们的生活围绕着金钱和财产运转。
- Here's part of an essay that my students helped me to write: 这是我的学生帮助我写作的文章的一部分：
- It is true that many people criticize modern society because it seems to be too materialistic. 诚然，许多人批评现代社会，因为它似乎过于拜金物质化。
- I agree with this to some extent, but I do not think it is the case that everyone is a victim of consumer culture. 我在某种程度上同意这一点，但我并不认为每个人都是消费文化的受害者。
- On the one hand, many people do seem to focus too much on money and possessions. 一方面，许多人似乎确实过于关注金钱和财产。
- Wherever we go, we are bombarded with advertising to sell us products and services, many of which we do not need. 无论我们走到哪里，铺天盖地的广告都在向我们推销产品和服务，其中许多是我们不需要的。
- For example, people may be persuaded to purchase the latest model of iPhone, when their old phone is still perfectly functional. 例如，当旧手机功能仍然完好时，人们可能会被劝说购买最新款的 iPhone。
- This could be seen as a demonstration that we are obsessive consumers; we buy things based on fashion and branding, and shopping has become a hobby or even an addiction. 这可以被视为我们是痴迷的消费者的证明；我们根据时尚和品牌购买物品，而购物已经成为一种爱好甚至是一种瘾。
- Task: Which phrases in the paragraphs would you highlight as 'band 7-9 vocabulary'? 任务：你会将段落中的哪些短语突出标记为“7-9分词汇”？
- People often ask me how to give a balanced answer for "agree or disagree" questions. 人们经常问我如何对“同意或不同意”的问题给出中立平衡的回答。
- Take this question for example: 以此题为例：
- Many people say that we now live in 'consumer societies' where money and possessions are given too

much importance. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 许多人说，我们现在生活在‘消费型社会’中，金钱和财产被赋予了过多的重要性。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？

- A clear introduction is vital when giving a balanced answer: 给出平衡回答时，清晰的开头段至关重要：
- It is sometimes argued that we live in a materialistic world and that we value money too highly. 有时人们认为我们生活在一个物质主义的世界里，过于看重金钱。
- In my opinion, some people are extremely money oriented, but many of us place more importance on other values. 在我看来，有些人极其崇尚金钱，但我们当中的许多人更看重其他价值。
- The big mistake that students make when trying to give a balanced answer is that they write about what "some people" and "other people" think. 学生在试图给出平衡回答时犯的大错是，他们描写“有些人”和“其他人”是怎么想的。
- This question asks for your views, not the views of other people. 这个问题询问的是你的观点，而不是其他人的观点。
- Notice how my introduction makes it clear that the essay is about my own views. 注意我的开头段是如何明确表达出这篇文章是关于我自己的观点的。

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'foreign tourists' essay

雅思写作任务 2：“外国游客”范文

- Foreign visitors should pay more than local visitors for cultural and historical attractions. To what extent do you agree or disagree with this opinion? 外国游客在参观文化和历史景点时应该比本地游客支付更高的费用。你在多大程度上同意或不同意这种观点？
- It is sometimes argued that tourists from overseas should be charged more than local residents to visit important sites and monuments. 有时人们争论说，海外游客在参观重要遗址和纪念碑时应该比当地居民支付更多的费用。
- I completely disagree with this idea. 我完全不同意这种观点。
- The argument in favour of higher prices for foreign tourists would be that cultural or historical attractions often depend on state subsidies to keep them going, which means that the resident population already pays money to these sites through the tax system. 支持对外国游客收取更高价格的论点是，文化或历史景点往往依赖国家补贴来维持运营，这意味着常住人口已经通过税收系统向这些景点支付了资金。
- However, I believe this to be a very shortsighted view. 然而，我认为这是一个非常有局限性/短视的观点。
- Foreign tourists contribute to the economy of the host country with the money they spend on a wide range of goods and services, including food, souvenirs, accommodation and travel. 外国游客通过在各种商品和服务上的消费（包括餐饮、纪念品、住宿和交通），为东道国的经济做出了贡献。
- The governments and inhabitants of every country should be happy to subsidise important tourist sites and encourage people from the rest of the world to visit them. 每个国家的政府和居民都应该乐于补贴重要的旅游景点，并鼓励世界其他地方的人们来参观。
- If travellers realised that they would have to pay more to visit historical and cultural attractions in a particular nation, they would perhaps decide not to go to that country on holiday. 如果游客意识到他们在

某个国家参观历史和文化景点时需要支付更多的费用，他们或许会决定不去那个国家度假。

- To take the UK as an example, the tourism industry and many related jobs rely on visitors coming to the country to see places like Windsor Castle or Saint Paul's Cathedral. 以英国为例，旅游业和许多相关工作依赖于来到该国参观温莎城堡或圣保罗大教堂等景点的游客。
- These two sites charge the same price regardless of nationality, and this helps to promote the nation's cultural heritage. 这两个景点无论国籍如何都收取相同的价格，这有助于弘扬国家的文化遗产。
- If overseas tourists stopped coming due to higher prices, there would be a risk of insufficient funding for the maintenance of these important buildings. 如果海外游客因价格过高而不再前来，维持这些重要建筑维护的资金可能会面临不足的风险。
- In conclusion, I believe that every effort should be made to attract tourists from overseas, and it would be counterproductive to make them pay more than local residents. 总之，我认为应该尽一切努力吸引来自海外的游客，而让他们支付比当地居民更高的费用将会适得其反。
- (269 words, band 9) (269 字，9 分范文)
- Last week I said that we needed a 'strong opinion' answer to the question above. 上周我说过我们需要对上述问题给出一个“立场鲜明”的回答。
- Here's my suggested outline for a 4-paragraph essay: 以下是我建议的 4 段式短文大纲：
 - 1. Introduction: make your opinion clear (e.g. I completely disagree)
2. 开头段：明确你的观点（例如：我完全不同意）
 - 1. First reason why you disagree
2. 你不同意的第一个原因
 - 1. Second reason why you disagree
2. 你不同意的第二个原因
 - 1. Conclusion: repeat / summarise your opinion
2. 结尾段：重复 / 总结你的观点
- Note: It is possible to mention the opposite view in one of the main paragraphs, but you should make it very clear that you disagree with it. 注意：可以在主体段落之一提及相反的观点，但你必须非常明确地表达你不同意该观点。
- In this lesson I wrote an introduction for a 'balanced opinion' answer. 在这节课中，我为一个“中立平衡观点”的回答写了一个开头段。
- Today we're going to look at a question which I think requires a 'strong opinion' answer: 今天我们要看一个我认为需要“强立场观点”回答的问题：
- I think it would become confusing if you tried to explain a balanced view for this question. 我认为如果你试图解释对这个问题的中立平衡看法，事情会变得令人困惑。
- The choice of opinion is simple: either foreign visitors should pay more, or they shouldn't. 观点的选择很简单：要么外国游客应该付更多钱，要么不应该。
- I'll show you how I would write an essay for this question next week. 下周我将向你们展示我会如何就这个

问题写一篇文章。

- For the moment, just compare the question above with the question here. 目前，只需将上面的问题与这里的题目进行对比即可。
- Make sure you understand why I'm suggesting a strong answer for one and a balanced answer for the other. 请确保你理解为什么我建议对其中一个给出强立场回答，而对另一个给出平衡回答。

IELTS Writing Task 2: from plan to paragraph

雅思写作任务 2：从计划到段落

- Let's plan and then write one main paragraph for the question below. 让我们针对下面的问题制定计划，然后写一个正文主体段。
- Economic progress is often used to measure a country's success. However, some people believe that other factors are more important. What other factors should also be considered when measuring a country's success? Do you think one factor is more important than others? 经济发展经常被用来衡量一个国家的成功。然而，有些人认为其他因素更重要。在衡量一个国家的成功时，还应该考虑哪些其他因素？你认为有某个因素比其他因素更重要吗？
- Here's a plan I wrote with my students: 这是我和学生们一起写的计划：
 - Paragraph about other factors: 关于其他因素的段落：
 - 1. Education for development of the country, providing future workforce.
2. 教育对于国家的发展、提供未来的劳动力至关重要。
 - 1. Good health system, living standards, life expectancy.
2. 良好的医疗体系、生活水平、预期寿命。
 - 1. Personal freedom / rights / equality e.g. equal opportunities for both genders.
2. 个人自由/权利/平等，例如两性平等的机会。
- Here's our full paragraph using the plan above: 以下是利用上述计划完成的完整段落：
- Standards of education, health and individual human rights should certainly be considered when measuring a country's status. 在衡量一个国家的地位时，当然应该考虑教育、卫生和个人人权的标准。
- A good education system is vital for the development of any nation, with schools, colleges and universities bearing the responsibility for the quality of future generations of workers. 一个好的教育体系对任何国家的发展都至关重要，中小学、大专院校承担着提升下一代工作者质量的责任。
- Healthcare provision is also an indicator of the standard of living within a country, and this can be measured by looking at average life expectancy rates or availability of medical services. 医疗保障也是一个国家生活水平的指标，这可以通过观察平均预期寿命或医疗服务的可及性来衡量。
- Finally, human rights and levels of equality could be taken into account. 最后，人权和平等程度也可以被纳入考量。
- For example, a country in which women do not have the same opportunities as men might be considered less successful than a country with better gender equality. 例如，一个女性没有与男性同等机

会的国家，可能会被认为不如一个性别平等做得更好的国家成功。

IELTS Writing Task 2: introduction and conclusion

雅思写作任务 2：开头段与结尾段

- Economic progress is often used to measure a country's success. However, some people believe that other factors are more important. What other factors should also be considered when measuring a country's success? Do you think one factor is more important than others? 经济发展经常被用来衡量一个国家的成功。然而，有些人认为其他因素更重要。在衡量一个国家的成功时，还应该考虑哪些其他因素？你认为有某个因素比其他因素更重要吗？
- Introduction: Introduce the topic and give a general answer to both questions. 开头段：引入主题并对这两个问题给出概括性的回答。
- The relative success of different countries is usually defined in economic terms. 不同国家的相对成功通常是用经济术语来定义的。
- There are several other factors, apart from the economy, that could be used to assess a country, and in my opinion education is the most important of all. 除了经济之外，还有其他几个因素可以用来评估一个国家，在我看来，教育是其中最重要的。
- Conclusion: Repeat / summarise your answer. 结尾段：重复 / 总结你的回答。
- In conclusion, nations can be assessed and compared in a variety of ways, but I would argue that the standard of a country's education system is the best indicator of its success. 总之，评估和比较国家的方式多种多样，但我认为，一个国家教育体系的标准是其成功与否的最佳指标。

IELTS Writing Task 2: argument or discussion?

雅思写作任务 2：议论文（Argument）还是讨论文（Discussion）？

- Many people ask me about the difference between an 'argument' (opinion) essay and a 'discussion' essay. 许多人问我‘辩论’（观点）类文章和‘讨论’类文章的区别。
- Here's an easy way to think about the difference: 这里有一个思考它们区别的简单方法：
 - When you argue, you are trying to persuade the other person to agree with your point of view. You might even get angry! 当你进行辩论时，你是在试图说服对方同意你的观点。你甚至可能会生气！
 - When you discuss, you consider different points of view, and nobody gets angry. 当你在进行讨论时，你会考虑不同的观点，而且没有人会生气。
- The question should make it very clear what it wants you to do. 题目应该非常明确地说明它需要你做什么。
- If it asks you to "discuss", you should write about both sides or two views. 如果题目要求你“讨论 (discuss)”，你应该写双方或两种观点。
- If the question asks whether you "agree or disagree", it's asking for your view. 如果题目问你是否“同意或不同意 (agree or disagree)”，它是在询问你的观点。
- For this type of question, give your opinion in the introduction and support it in the rest of the essay. 对于这种类型的题目，在开头段给出你的观点，并在文章的其余部分支持这一观点。

- Develop an argument that persuades the reader to agree with you. 展开论述以说服读者同意你的看法。
- Note: you can have a strong view or a balanced view - it's your choice. 注意：你可以持强烈的立场，也可以持中立平衡的看法——这是你的选择。

IELTS Writing Task 2: children's upbringing

雅思写作任务 2：儿童抚养

- Children who are brought up in families that do not have large amounts of money are better prepared to deal with the problems of adult life than children brought up by wealthy parents. To what extent do you agree or disagree with this opinion? 在经济并不宽裕的家庭中长大的孩子，比富裕父母抚养的孩子能更好地应对成年生活的各种问题。你在多大程度上同意或不同意这种观点？
- Here are two quick tasks related to the question above. 以下是与上述问题相关的两个快速任务。
 1. Vocabulary: fill the gaps in the following paragraph:
 2. 词汇：填空完成以下段落：
- On the one hand, I agree that some children from less wealthy _ might be in a better position to _ adult life. 一方面，我同意一些来自不太富裕的_的孩子可能会更好地_成年生活。
- Children whose parents have less money learn to fight, struggle and solve problems on a daily _. 父母钱较少的孩子学会了在日常_中去拼搏、挣扎和解决问题。
- They are forced to rely on _ because they have less financial help from parents and cannot get what they want as soon as they want it. 他们被迫依靠_，因为他们从父母那里得到的财政帮助较少，并且不能一想得到什么就立刻得到。
- For example, poorer children may have to wait until a birthday to receive a toy or game that they have asked for, and this encourages them to learn patience. 例如，较贫困的孩子可能要等到生日才能收到他们想要的玩具或游戏，这鼓励了他们学会耐心。
- These children will also learn the importance of managing money and the value of hard *, **which will be vital _ in later life.** 这些孩子还会学会理财的重要性以及辛勤_的价值，这将在以后的生活中成为至关重要的***。
- 1. Opinions: think of some ideas to support the opposite point of view.
 2. 观点：想出一些支持相反观点的想法。

IELTS Writing Task 2: better linking

雅思写作任务 2：更好的逻辑衔接

- Most students learn simple linking words (firstly, secondly, furthermore etc.). 大多数学生学会了简单的连接词（firstly, secondly, furthermore 等）。
- But did you know that there are other, more sophisticated ways to link your ideas? 但你知道还有其他更高级的方式来衔接你的观点吗？
- Here are some of them: 以下是其中的一部分：

- Use this or these to refer to the idea in the previous sentence. 使用 this 或 these 来指代上一句中的观点。
- Use pronouns like it and they to refer to nouns you have already used. 使用代词如 it 和 they 来指代你已经用过的名词。
- Repeat a key word throughout the paragraph. 在整个段落中重复一个关键词。
- Repeat a key idea in different ways. 用不同的方式重复核心观点。
- Develop an idea from 'general' to 'specific'. 将观点从“概括/抽象”展开为“具体”。
- You might not notice this type of linking because it seems so natural. 你可能不会注意到这种类型的连接，因为它看起来太自然了。
- Click here to see a paragraph that demonstrates the 5 techniques described above. 点击这里查看演示上述 5 种技巧的段落。
- Better linking 更好的衔接
- Linking isn't just about using words like 'firstly', 'furthermore' and 'moreover'. 衔接不仅仅是使用诸如 'firstly', 'furthermore' 和 'moreover' 之类的词。
- There are more sophisticated ways to hold a paragraph together. Here's a good example: 有更高级的方法可以将段落紧密结合在一起。这是一个很好的例子：
 - these, this = refer back to a previous idea these, this = 回指先前的观点
 - which, they = pronouns refer back to a noun or noun phrase (e.g. they = artworks) which, they = 代词回指名词或名词短语（例如：they = 艺术品）
 - art = key word repeated because it is the main theme of the paragraph art = 重复关键词，因为它是段落的主题
 - art projects = key idea that is repeated in different ways, showing variety of vocabulary art projects = 以不同方式重复的核心观点，展示了词汇的多样性
 - the state, the UK = general to specific: general idea which is developed in greater detail the state, the UK = 概括到具体：宏观概念被展开为更详细的细节
- Many IELTS students become obsessed with 'linkers' - words or phrases that link ideas together in a paragraph e.g. firstly, secondly, furthermore, moreover. 许多雅思考生过于痴迷于“连接词”——即段落中连接观点的词或短语，例如首先、其次、此外、而且等。
- There is nothing wrong with using linkers, and they can certainly help you to write good paragraphs. 使用连接词没有任何问题，它们当然可以帮助你写出好的段落。
- However, linkers become a problem when they are the only thing that students care about. 然而，当连接词成为学生唯一关心的东西时，它就成了问题。
- Examiners care much more about the content between the linkers. 考官更关心的其实是连接词之间的实际内容。
- Task: Here's a useful exercise to get you focusing on content rather than linking: Try writing a coherent paragraph without using any linking words or phrases at all. 任务：这里有一个有用的练习，可以让你关注

内容而不是衔接：尝试在完全不使用任何连接词或短语的情况下写出一个连贯的段落。

(答案参考)

1. family 2) deal 3) basis 4) problems 5) work 6) lesson
2. family 2) deal 3) basis 4) money 5) hard work 6) role

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'artists' essay

雅思写作任务 2：“艺术家”范文

- Here's a full essay that I wrote with my students about the topic below. 这是我和我的学生针对以下话题写的一篇完整范文。
- Some people think that governments should give financial support to creative artists such as painters and musicians. Others believe that creative artists should be funded by alternative sources. Discuss both views and give your own opinion. 有些人认为政府应该向画家和音乐家等创意艺术家提供资助。其他人则认为创意艺术家应该由其他资金来源赞助。讨论两种观点并给出你自己的意见。
- People have different views about the funding of creative artists. 对于创意艺术家的资助，人们有不同的看法。
- While some people disagree with the idea of government support for artists, I believe that money for art projects should come from both governments and other sources. 虽然有些人不同意政府资助艺术家的观点，但我认为艺术项目的资金应该同时来自政府和其他渠道。
- Some art projects definitely require help from the state. 某些艺术项目绝对需要国家的帮助。
- In the UK, there are many works of art in public spaces, such as streets or squares in city centres. 在英国，公共场所（如市中心的街道或广场）有许多艺术品。
- In Liverpool, for example, there are several new statues and sculptures in the docks area of the city, which has been redeveloped recently. 例如在利物浦，城市最近重新开发的码头区就有几座新的雕像和雕塑。
- These artworks represent culture, heritage and history. 这些艺术品代表了文化、遗产和历史。
- They serve to educate people about the city, and act as landmarks or talking points for visitors and tourists. 它们起到了教育人们了解这座城市的作用，并作为地标或游客热议的话题。
- Governments and local councils should pay creative artists to produce this kind of art, because without their funding our cities would be much less interesting and attractive. 政府和地方议会应该支付费用让艺术家创作这类艺术，因为如果没有他们的资金，我们的城市趣味性和吸引力都会大打折扣。
- On the other hand, I can understand the arguments against government funding for art. 另一方面，我也能理解反对政府资助艺术的论点。
- The main reason for this view is that governments have more important concerns. 持这种观点的首要原因是政府有更重要的事情需要关注。
- For example, state budgets need to be spent on education, healthcare, infrastructure and security, among other areas. 例如，国家预算需要用于教育、医疗、基础设施和安全等领域。

- These public services are vital for a country to function properly, whereas the work of creative artists, even in public places, is a luxury. 这些公共服务对于一个国家的正常运转至关重要，而创意艺术家的工作（即使是在公共场所）也是一种奢侈品。
- Another reason for this opinion is that artists do a job like any other professional, and they should therefore earn their own money by selling their work. 这种观点的另一个原因是，艺术家和任何其他专业人士一样是在做一份工作，因此他们应该通过出售自己的作品来赚钱。
- In conclusion, there are good reasons why artists should rely on alternative sources of financial support, but in my opinion government help is sometimes necessary. 总之，艺术家应该依靠其他资金来源的支持是有充分理由的，但在在我看来，政府的帮助有时是必要的。
- Last week I asked you to try rewriting the third paragraph in this essay. 上周我让你们尝试重写这篇文章的第三段。
- The paragraph below is an edited compilation of students' ideas. 下面的段落是学生观点的精修汇编。
- I think it's good enough for a band 9. 我认为这足以达到 9 分水平。
- On the other hand, I can understand the view taken by many people that artists should not expect the state to fund their work. 另一方面，我能理解许多人的观点，即艺术家不应该指望国家为其工作提供资金。
- Most musicians and the majority of painters make a living by performing or selling their artistic creations to fans or collectors; they would not expect to receive any help from their governments. 大多数音乐家和绝大多数画家通过向粉丝或收藏家表演或出售他们的艺术创作来谋生；他们并不指望从政府那里获得任何帮助。
- Industry sponsorships can be another useful source of revenue for creative artists. 行业赞助可以是创意艺术家的另一个有用收入来源。
- For example, media companies like the mobile giant Apple are often willing to pay huge fees to inspirational designers who work on their advertising campaigns, product packaging, and even the appearance of their electronic devices. 例如，像手机巨头苹果这样的媒体公司往往愿意向富有灵感的设计师支付巨额费用，这些设计师参与了他们的广告宣传、产品包装甚至电子设备的外观设计。
- Finally, some artists may be lucky enough to receive donations from wealthy individuals. 最后，一些艺术家可能会幸运地收到富豪个人的捐款。

IELTS Writing Task 2: main paragraph methods

雅思写作任务 2：主体段写作方法

- I always tell my students to choose a method and stick to it. 我总是告诉我的学生选择一种方法并坚持下去。
- For main paragraphs, I teach them two easy ways to organise their ideas: 对于正文主体段，我教他们两种简单的组织观点的方案：

1. Idea, explain, example (观点 -> 解释 -> 举例)

- If you have one main idea, this easy format will help you to build a good paragraph. 如果你只有一个主要观点，这个简单的格式将帮助你构建一个好的段落。

- Click here and here to see how I use this method. 点击[这里](#)和[这里](#)查看我是如何使用这种方法的。
- A good way to write main body paragraphs is this: Start with an idea; Explain it in detail; Give an example
写作正文段落的一个好方法是：从一个观点开始；详细解释它；举一个例子
- Here's an example of how I 'build' a paragraph using the above method: 这是我使用上述方法“构建”段落的示例：
- A sense of competition is necessary for success in life, and should therefore be encouraged. 竞争意识对于人生的成功是必要的，因此应该予以鼓励。
- Competition motivates children to get good grades at school or become better at sports, while adults compete to climb the career ladder. 竞争激励孩子们在学校取得好成绩或在体育方面表现更好，而成年人则通过竞争来提升职业阶梯。
- In a job interview, for example, candidates compete to show that they are the most qualified, hard-working and competent person for the post. 例如，在求职面试中，求职者相互竞争，以表明自己是该职位最合格、最勤奋和最有能力的人选。
- Note: What's the topic of the paragraph above? What do you think the question was? 注意：上述段落的主题是什么？你认为题目是什么？
- The "idea, explain, example" format is a good way to organise your main paragraphs. “观点 -> 解释 -> 举例”的格式是组织主体段落的好方法。
- Start with the main idea of the paragraph, explain it in more detail, then give an example. 从段落的核心观点开始，更详细地解释它，然后举个例子。
- A variation on this format is "idea, example, explain". 这种格式的变体是“观点 -> 举例 -> 解释”。
- Here's a paragraph that I wrote with my students about last week's topic: 这是我和学生们就上周的话题写的一个段落：
- Some art projects definitely require help from the state. 某些艺术项目绝对需要国家的帮助。
- In the UK, there are many works of art in public spaces, such as streets or squares in city centres. 在英国，公共场所（如市中心街道或广场）有许多艺术品。
- In Liverpool, for example, there are several new statues and sculptures in the docks area of the city, which has been redeveloped recently. 例如，在利物浦，城市最近重新开发的码头区就有几座新的雕像和雕塑。
- These artworks represent culture, heritage and history. 这些艺术品代表了文化、遗产和历史。
- They serve to educate people about the city, and act as landmarks or talking points for visitors and tourists. 它们起到了教育人们了解这座城市的作用，并作为地标或游客热议的话题。
- Governments and local councils should pay creative artists to produce this kind of art, because without their funding our cities would be much less interesting and attractive. 政府和地方议会应该付钱给创意艺术家创作这类艺术，因为如果没有资金，我们的城市将失去许多乐趣和吸引力。
- Task: Analyse the paragraph. What role does each sentence play? 任务：分析该段落。每句话起到了什么作用？

2. Firstly, secondly, finally (首先，其次，最后)

- If you have two or three ideas, just use this format. 如果你有两到三个观点，直接使用这种格式即可。
- Miss the "finally" if you only have two ideas, and remember that you can use alternative words for the same structure (e.g. The main reason, another reason, also, furthermore). 如果你只有两个观点，可以省略“finally”；记住，你可以使用替代词表达相同的结构（例如：主要原因、另一个原因、此外、而且）。
- Click here and here. 点击[这里](#)和[这里](#)。
- The paragraph I wrote for last week's lesson (repeated below) is structured in the following way: 我为上周课程写的段落（下文重复）结构如下：
 1. Topic sentence (主题句)
 2. Firstly (首先)
 3. Example (例子)
 4. Secondly (其次)
 5. Finally (最后)
- I think this is a good way to organise a paragraph. 我认为这是组织段落的好方法。
- However, it's best not to use the same structure twice in one essay. 然而，在一篇文章中最好不要两次使用相同的结构。
- Compare the two paragraphs below. How did I structure the second one to avoid repeating "Firstly, Secondly, Finally"? 对比下面的两个段落。我是如何构建第二个段落以避免重复使用“首先，其次，最后”的？
- First main paragraph 第一个主体段：
 - There are good reasons why some people feel the need to make significant changes to their lives from time to time. 有些人觉得有必要时不时对自己的生活做出重大改变，这是有充分理由的。
 - Firstly, any new situation that a person encounters can be an opportunity to learn and grow as a person. 首先，一个人遇到的任何新情况都可以成为学习和成长的契机。
 - A new job, for instance, might present challenges that push the person to adapt, acquire new knowledge, or add to his or her skill set. 例如，一份新工作可能会带来挑战，迫使这个人去适应、获取新知识或增加技能储备。
 - Secondly, a change can represent a break with the past and an old routine which has become boring and predictable. 其次，改变可以意味着与过去打破联系，摆脱已经变得枯燥且可预测的旧日常。
 - Finally, as well as making life more fun and interesting, new experiences can be good for our physical and mental health. 最后，除了让生活更有趣之外，新的体验对我们的身心健康也有好处。
- Second main paragraph 第二个主体段：
 - On the other hand, it is understandable why people might avoid change. 另一方面，人们为什么避开改变也是可以理解的。
 - Whenever people are forced to change their lifestyles, jobs or even to move house, they are likely to experience stress and worry as they try to adapt to the new situation. 每当人们被迫改变生活方式、工作甚至搬家时，当他们试图适应新环境时，往往会感到压力和焦虑。
 - By contrast, we feel comfortable and confident when we stay with what we know. 相比之下，当我们保持

在熟悉的领域时，我们会感到舒适和自信。

- The decision to persist with a course of action or stick to one chosen path often leads to greater success in life. 坚持一种做法或专注于所选道路的决定往往会在人生中带来更大的成功。
- For example, by staying in the same job for many years, a person can become an expert in his or her field, which will lead to better opportunities for promotions and career progression. 例如，通过在同一份工作中留任多年，一个人可以成为该领域的专家，从而带来更好的晋升和职业发展机会。
- A few people have asked me whether using "firstly, secondly, finally" to organise a paragraph is too easy. 有些人问我，使用“首先，其次，最后”来组织段落是否过于简单。
- My answer is that using easy organising language like "firstly, secondly, finally" allows you to focus on the real content of what you are writing - topic vocabulary, collocations, examples. 我的回答是，使用简单明了的组织语言如“首先，其次，最后”可以让你集中精力写实质内容——主题词汇、固定搭配和例子。
- This is what the examiner wants to see. 这正是考官想看到的。
- You can get a band 9 using "firstly, secondly, finally" if the ideas between these linking words are good. 如果这些连接词之间的观点很好，即使使用“首先，其次，最后”，你也能拿到 9 分。
- Some simple alternatives to "firstly, secondly, finally" could be: “首先，其次，最后”的一些简单替代方案可以是：
 - The main reason why I believe... is... / Another argument is... / Also,... 我之所以认为.....的主要原因是..... / 另一个论点是..... / 此外，
 - One problem is that... / Furthermore,... / Another drawback is that... 一个问题是..... / 此外， / 另一个缺点是.....
 - From a business perspective,... / In terms of education,... / From a social point of view,... (this could work for the paragraph in last week's lesson) 从商业的角度来看..... / 从教育的角度来看..... / 从社会角度来看.....（这适用于上周课程中的段落）

IELTS Writing Task 2: how to write faster

雅思写作任务 2：如何提高写作速度

- A student asked me for some tips about how to write task 2 essays faster. 一个学生向我请教关于如何更快地完成任务 2 短文写作的技巧。
- Here's my advice: 以下是我的建议：
 - 1. The first step is to write better, not faster.
2. 第一步是写得更好，而不是更快。
 - If you can't get the score you need when it takes you 2 hours to write an essay, you won't be able to write a good essay in 40 minutes. 如果你花 2 个小时写文章都拿不到需要的分数，那你不可能在 40 分钟内写出一篇好文章。
 - 1. Click here to read about a student who started slowly and got faster with practice.
2. 点击这里阅读有关一个起初很慢但通过练习变得越来越快的学生的情况。

- 1. The next step is to break the 40 minutes into smaller parts.
 - 2. 下一步是将 40 分钟分解成更小的碎片。
- For example, you could practise writing introductions in only 5 minutes. 例如，你可以练习在短短 5 分钟内写完开头段。
- Don't work on full essays yet; just practise the parts according to my advice in this lesson. 暂时先不要写全文；只需按照本课的建议分块练习。
- 1. Separate the 'thinking' from the 'writing'.
 - 2. 将“思考”与“写作”分开。
- I do all my thinking (planning or brainstorming) in the first 10 minutes. 我在前 10 分钟完成所有的思考（规划或头脑风暴）。
- When I'm happy with my essay plan, I start writing. 当我对文章计划感到满意时，我才开始动笔。
- I try to stick to my plan so that I can focus on writing rather than more thinking. 我尽量坚持我的计划，这样我就可以专注于写作本身，而不是频繁停下来再构思。
- 1. Finally, remember that improvements happen gradually.
 - 2. 最后，记住进步是循序渐进的。
- You have to be prepared to do the hard work: practising lots of essays and parts of essays, preparing ideas and opinions for topics, building your vocabulary repertoire, and learning from mistakes. 你必须准备好付出艰苦的努力：练习大量的完整短文和段落写作、为各个话题准备观点和见解、丰富你的词汇库并从错误中吸取教训。
- Do the work and you'll get better and faster! 努力练习，你会写得更好、更快！

IELTS Advice: the "four-hour essay"

雅思建议：“耗时四小时的短文”

- One of my students was worried that it took her 4 hours to write a band 7 essay for homework. 我的一个学生很担心，因为她花了 4 个小时才写出一篇能达到 7 分水平的课后作业文章。
- In my opinion, spending 4 hours to write an essay is a good idea. 在我看来，花 4 个小时写一篇文章是一个好主意。
- This kind of hard work leads to great results! 这种刻苦的训练能带来出色的成果！
- The important thing is to be able to write your first band 7 essay. 最重要的是具备写出第一篇 7 分文章的能力。
- At first it might take you 4 hours, but you will get faster with practice. 起初可能需要花上 4 个小时，但熟能生巧，速度自然会提升。
- PS. The student I mentioned got a band 7 in her exam about 6 weeks later! 顺便提一句，我提到的那个学生在大约 6 周后的考试中拿到了 7 分！

IELTS Writing Task 2: how to use your 40 minutes

雅思写作任务 2：如何合理分配 40 分钟时间

- You have 40 minutes for task 2, so try organising your time in the following way. 你在任务 2 上有 40 分钟的时间，因此请尝试按照以下方式组织你的时间。
- Please note that these are suggestions, not rules. 请注意，这些只是建议，并非死板的规则。
- First 10 minutes (前 10 分钟): Read the question and make sure you understand what it is asking you to do. 审题，确保你完全理解题目要你做什么。Write a plan for a 4-paragraph essay (introduction, 2 main paragraphs, conclusion) and spend most of the 10 minutes thinking of ideas for the 2 main paragraphs. 写下一个 4 段式短文的大纲（开头段、2 个主体段、结尾段），并将这 10 分钟的大部分时间用于构思 2 个主体段的观点。
- 5 minutes (5 分钟): Write your introduction: 2 sentences are enough. 撰写你的开头段：两句话就足够了。
- 20 minutes (20 分钟): Spend 10 minutes on each of your main body paragraphs. 在你的每个正文主体段上各花费 10 分钟。These are they most important part of your essay, and the key to a high score. 这些是你文章中最核心的部分，也是取得高分的关键。
- Last 5 minutes (最后 5 分钟): Write a quick conclusion then check your work. 快速写完结尾段，然后检查文章。

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'animal testing' essay

雅思写作任务 2：“动物实验”范文

- Nowadays animal experiments are widely used to develop new medicines and to test the safety of other products. Some people argue that these experiments should be banned because it is morally wrong to cause animals to suffer, while others are in favour of them because of their benefits to humanity. Discuss both views and give your own opinion. 如今，动物实验被广泛用于开发新药和测试其他产品的安全性。有些人主张应该禁止这些实验，因为让动物受苦在道德上是错误的，而另一些人则因其对人类的益处而赞成这些实验。讨论这两种观点并给出你自己的意见。
- It is true that medicines and other products are routinely tested on animals before they are cleared for human use. 诚然，药品和其他产品在获批准供人类使用之前，通常都会在动物身上进行测试。
- While I tend towards the viewpoint that animal testing is morally wrong, I would have to support a limited amount of animal experimentation for the development of medicines. 虽然我倾向于动物实验在道德上是错误的观点，但我不得不支持为药物开发而进行的有限度的动物实验。
- On the one hand, there are clear ethical arguments against animal experimentation. 一方面，存在着反对动物实验的明确伦理论点。
- To use a common example of this practice, laboratory mice may be given an illness so that the effectiveness of a new drug can be measured. 举一个这种做法的常见例子，实验室老鼠可能会被感染疾病，以便可以测量新药的有效性。
- Opponents of such research argue that humans have no right to subject animals to this kind of trauma, and that the lives of all creatures should be respected. 此类研究的反对者主张，人类无权让动物承受这种创伤，所有生物的生命都应该受到尊重。
- They believe that the benefits to humans do not justify the suffering caused, and that scientists should

use alternative methods of research. 他们认为对人类的好处并不能证明所造成的痛苦是合理的，科学家应该使用替代的研究方法。

- On the other hand, reliable alternatives to animal experimentation may not always be available. 另一方面，动物实验的可靠替代方案可能并不总是可行。
- Supporters of the use of animals in medical research believe that a certain amount of suffering on the part of mice or rats can be justified if human lives are saved. 在医学研究中使用动物的支持者认为，如果能够挽救人类的生命，小鼠或大鼠承受一定程度的痛苦是合理的。
- They argue that opponents of such research might feel differently if a member of their own families needed a medical treatment that had been developed through the use of animal experimentation. 他们主张，如果反对者的家人需要通过动物实验开发出的医疗手段来救治，他们可能会有不同的看法。
- Personally, I agree with the banning of animal testing for non-medical products, but I feel that it may be a necessary evil where new drugs and medical procedures are concerned. 就个人而言，我赞成禁止对非医疗产品进行动物实验，但我认为当涉及新药和医疗程序时，这可能是一种“必要的恶”。
- In conclusion, it seems to me that it would be wrong to ban testing on animals for vital medical research until equally effective alternatives have been developed. 总之，在我看来，在开发出同样有效的替代方案之前，禁止在至关重要的医学研究中进行动物实验是错误的。
- (270 words, band 9) (270 字，9 分范文)

IELTS Writing Task 2: discuss both views

雅思写作任务 2：讨论双方观点

- Wednesday, June 12, 2013 2013年6月12日，星期三
- Last week I asked you to share your "discuss both views" questions. 上周我请大家分享你们关于“讨论双方观点”的题目。
- I've chosen a question shared by JK: 我挑选了一个由 JK 分享的问题：
- Nowadays animal experiments are widely used to develop new medicines and to test the safety of other products. Some people argue that these experiments should be banned because it is morally wrong to cause animals to suffer, while others are in favour of them because of their benefits to humanity. Discuss both views and give your own opinion. 如今，动物实验被广泛用于开发新药和测试其他产品的安全性。有些人主张应该禁止这些实验，因为让动物受苦在道德上是错误的，而另一些人则因其对人类的益处而赞成这些实验。讨论这两种观点并给出你自己的意见。
- Here are the steps I would take to answer this question: 以下是我回答这个问题所采取的步骤：
 - First we need ideas. I would start by writing down some arguments for and against animal testing. I covered this topic in my ebook (chapter 2), so I already have some good ideas in my head. 首先我们需要点子。我会先写下一些支持和反对动物实验的论点。我在电子书（第2章）中涵盖了这个话题，所以我的脑海里已经有一些好主意了。
 - Next we can decide on our own view. Looking at the ideas you wrote down, you need to make a decision. A good 'middle point' might be that animal experiments should only be used for the most important medical research. 接下来我们可以决定自己的观点。看着你写下的点子，你需要做出

决定。一个很好的“中间折中点”可能是动物实验应该仅用于最重要的医学研究。

- Now we need to organise our ideas. Always stick to the 4-paragraph structure; you don't need an extra paragraph for your own view because you agree with elements of the two views stated in the question. 现在我们需要组织我们的观点。始终坚持 4 段式结构；你不需要为自己的观点单独写一段，因为你赞同题目中阐述的两种观点的部分元素。
 - Finally we're ready to write the essay. Keep your introduction and conclusion short. Spend most of your time on the main body paragraphs. 最后我们准备好写文章了。保持开头段和结尾段简短。把大部分时间花在主体段落上。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (30) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (30)
 - Wednesday, June 05, 2013 2013年6月5日, 星期三
 - Task 2 questions often ask you to Discuss both views and give your own opinion. 任务 2 的问题经常要求你“讨论双方观点并给出自己的意见”。
 - Here's how I structure a 4-paragraph essay for this kind of question: 这是我为此类问题构建 4 段式短文的方式：

1. Introduction (2 sentences): 开头段 (2 句话) :

- First introduce the topic. I often begin with the phrase "People have different views about...". 首先引入主题。我经常以“关于.....人们有不同的看法”这句话开头。
- In the second sentence, mention both views and your own opinion. I often use the word "although" in this sentence e.g. Although there are good arguments in favour of..., I personally believe that... 在第二句话中，提及两种观点和你自己的意见。我经常在这句话中使用“although”一词，例如“虽然有充分的理由支持.....，但我个人认为.....”

2. The first view (第一种观点)

3. The second view (I make it clear that I agree with this view) 第二种观点 (我明确表示我同意这种观点)

4. Conclusion: summarise both views and your own opinion 结尾段：总结两种观点和你自己的意见

- Please share any 'discuss both views' questions that you find difficult in the comments area below. I'll choose one question to look at next week. 请在下面的评论区分享任何你觉得困难的“讨论双方观点”的问题。我下周会选一个问题来看。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (42) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (42)

IELTS Writing Task 2: find the good vocabulary

雅思写作任务 2：寻找优质词汇

- Wednesday, May 29, 2013 2013年5月29日, 星期三
- In last week's lesson I explained what I mean by 'band 7 vocabulary'. 在上周的课程中，我解释了我所说的“7分词汇”是什么意思。

- Read the lesson again, then study the paragraph below. 再次阅读该课程，然后学习下面的段落。
- Which words or phrases in the following paragraph might be considered 'band 7 or higher'? 以下段落中的哪些单词或短语可以被视为“7分或更高分”？
- It is true that there are some disadvantages to learning a foreign language at primary school age. 诚然，在小学阶段学习外语确实存在一些劣势。
- The main problem is that young children need to study other subjects which can be considered as more important than a second language. 主要问题是年幼的孩子需要学习其他被认为比第二语言更重要的学科。
- The core subjects in most primary schools are the mother tongue language, mathematics and science, and it can be argued that lessons in a new language take valuable study time away from these key disciplines, as well as causing confusion in the young learners. 大多数小学的核心科目是母语、数学和科学，可以说，新语言课占据了这些核心学科宝贵的学习时间，并且还会给年幼的学习者带来困惑。
- In particular, some people might worry that lessons in the new language could delay the development of a child's first language. 特别是，有些人可能会担心新语言课程可能会推迟孩子母语的发展。
- Note: The paragraph above would be part of my answer to this question. 注意：上述段落将是我对该问题回答的一部分。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (32) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (32)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'band 7 vocabulary'

雅思写作任务 2：“7分词汇”定义

- Wednesday, May 22, 2013 2013年5月22日，星期三
- I sometimes use the term 'band 7 vocabulary' and several people have asked me to explain what I mean by this. Here goes: 我有时会使用“7分词汇”这个词，有几个人让我解释一下这是什么意思。具体如下：
 1. First, when I say 'band 7 vocabulary', I'm talking about vocabulary that could help you to get a band 7 or higher. 首先，当我说到“7分词汇”时，我指的是可以帮助你获得 7 分或更高分数的词汇。
 2. There is no list of band 7 vocabulary that you can use in any essay. 没有一份现成的“7分词汇表”可以在任何文章中通用。
 3. 'Band 7 vocabulary' refers to words and phrases that relate to the question topic. For example, a phrase like "delay the development of a child's first language" would be band 7 vocabulary, but a linking word like "moreover" would not. “7分词汇”指的是与题目话题相关的单词和短语。例如，像“delay the development of a child's first language（推迟儿童母语的发展）”这样的短语就是 7 分词汇，而像“moreover”这样的连接词则不是。
 4. Examiners are looking for 'less common' vocabulary. They wouldn't expect many students to write "delay the development of a child's first language", so this phrase would impress them. 考官寻找的是“不那么常见/地道”的词汇。他们不会预料到有许多学生能写出“delay the development of a child's first language”，因此这个短语会给他们留下深刻印象。
 5. Remember that we are not looking for 'big' words that are difficult to understand. We are looking for groups of words used naturally and accurately together. The phrase "delay the development

of a child's first language" is easy to understand, but not many students would think to use it. 记住，我们不是在寻找难以理解的“大词/冷僻词”。我们在寻找自然且准确地搭配在一起的词组。短语“delay the development of a child's first language”很容易理解，但没有多少学生能想到使用它。

- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (21) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (21)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'language learning' topic

雅思写作任务 2：“语言学习”话题

- Wednesday, May 15, 2013 2013年5月15日，星期三
- My students and I worked on this question from Cambridge IELTS 9: 我和学生们一起研究了剑桥雅思 9 中的这道题目：
- Some experts believe that it is better for children to begin learning a foreign language at primary school rather than secondary school. Do the advantages of this outweigh the disadvantages? 一些专家认为，儿童在小学而不是中学开始学习外语更好。这样做的优点大于缺点吗？
- Here's our plan for a 4-paragraph essay: 这是我们撰写的 4 段式文章规划：
 - 1. Introduction: Topic = best age to learn a foreign language. Our opinion = better to learn at primary school age.
2. 开头段：主题 = 学习外语的最佳年龄。我们的观点 = 在小学阶段学习更好。
 - 1. Disadvantages of learning languages at primary age: other subjects are more important at that age (maths, mother tongue language, science), learning a new language is confusing and wastes time, could delay development of child's first language.
2. 小学阶段学习语言的缺点：在该年龄段其他科目更重要（数学、母语、科学），学习新语言令人困惑且浪费时间，可能会推迟孩子母语的发展。
 - 1. Advantages of learning languages at primary age: young children learn faster, they are less self-conscious or shy, they pick up the pronunciation better, they enjoy copying and learning through games, nowadays languages are just as important as maths etc.
2. 小学阶段学习语言的优点：幼童学习得更快，他们不太害羞或拘束，他们能更好地掌握发音，他们喜欢通过游戏模仿和学习，如今语言和数学等科目一样重要。
 - 1. Conclusion: repeat / summarise our answer.
2. 结尾段：重复 / 总结我们的回答。
- The plan took us 10 minutes to write. 写这个计划花了我们 10 分钟。
- With a plan like this, it should be easy to write a good essay in 30 minutes. 有了这样的计划，在 30 分钟内写出一篇好文章应该很容易。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (46) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (46)

IELTS Writing Task 2: when to give your opinion

雅思写作任务 2：何时表达你的观点

- Wednesday, May 08, 2013 2013年5月8日，星期三
- Do the following questions ask for your opinion or not? 以下问题是否要求你给出观点？
 1. To what extent do you agree or disagree? (你在多大程度上同意或不同意？)
 2. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages. (讨论优点和缺点。)
 3. Discuss both views and give your opinion. (讨论双方观点并给出你的意见。)
 4. Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages? (优点大于缺点吗？)
 5. Is this a positive or negative development? (这是一个积极的发展还是消极的发展？)
 6. What are the benefits and drawbacks? (有哪些好处和弊端？)
- Answers (答案):
 - Numbers 2 and 6 are discussion questions. Discuss both sides of the issue, but don't give an opinion about which side you agree with. 第 2 和第 6 题是讨论类问题。讨论问题的双方，但不要就你赞同哪一方给出观点。
 - Numbers 1 and 5 are opinion questions. Give your opinion and support it. If you have a strong opinion, you don't need to mention the other side of the argument. 第 1 和第 5 题是观点类问题。给出你的观点并支持它。如果你持强烈的立场，则不需要提及论点的另一方。
 - Numbers 3 and 4 can be called discussion + opinion questions. Discuss both sides and make your opinion clear too. 第 3 和第 4 题可以被称为“讨论 + 观点”类问题。讨论双方，并同时明确你的观点。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (23) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (23)

IELTS Writing Task 2: quick conclusions

雅思写作任务 2：快速完成结尾段

- Wednesday, May 01, 2013 2013年5月1日，星期三
- The easiest way to write a short, effective conclusion is to paraphrase what you wrote in your introduction. 写出简短有效结尾段的最简单方法，就是改写你在开头段中写过的内容。
- Let's try this with the introduction I wrote last week. 让我们用我上周写的开头段来试试这种方法。
- Introduction (开头段):
 - It is true that the top sports people earn incredibly high salaries. Although reasons can be given to justify this, I personally believe that sports stars should be paid much less. 诚然，顶尖体育明星赚取着极其高昂的薪水。虽然可以给出理由证明这是合理的，但我个人认为体育明星的薪酬应该低得多。
- Conclusion (loosely paraphrasing the introduction) 结尾段（对开头段进行概括性改写）：
 - In conclusion, I do not accept the argument that sports professionals deserve to be paid so much more than people who do other important jobs. 总之，我不接受体育专业人员应该比从事其他重要工作的人获得更高薪酬的论点。

- Note: Notice that I wrote "loosely paraphrasing" (I paraphrased the overall idea, rather than word for word). 注意：注意我写的是“概括性改写”（我改写的是整体观点，而不是逐字逐句地改写）。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (14) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (14)

IELTS Writing Task 2: ideas and planning

雅思写作任务 2：观点与规划

- Wednesday, April 24, 2013 2013年4月24日，星期三
- Here's a question that my students and I looked at recently: 这是我和学生们最近研究的一道题目：
- Successful sports professionals can earn a great deal more money than people in other important professions. Some people think this is fully justified while others think it is unfair. Discuss both these views and give your own opinion. 成功的体育专业人员可以比其他重要领域的专业人员赚多得多的钱。有些人认为这完全合理，而另一些人则认为这不公平。讨论这两种观点并给出你自己的意见。
- We spent 10 minutes planning, then we wrote half of the essay together: 我们花了 10 分钟做规划，然后一起写了文章的一半：
- It is true that the top sports people earn incredibly high salaries. Although reasons can be given to justify this, I personally believe that sports stars should be paid much less. 诚然，顶尖体育明星赚取着极其高昂的薪水。虽然可以给出理由证明这是合理的，但我个人认为体育明星的薪酬应该低得多。
- There are several reasons why some people support high incomes in sport. 有一些原因可以解释为什么有些人支持体育界的高收入。
- Firstly, people who reach the highest levels in any sport must be uniquely talented. 首先，在任何体育运动中达到顶尖水平的人都必须具备独特的才能。
- For example, it is rare to find someone with the football skills of Messi or Ronaldo, and it can be argued that these players deserve salaries that reflect their abilities. 例如，很难找到具有梅西或罗纳尔多那种足球技巧的人，可以说是这些球员配得上体现其能力的薪水。
- Secondly, even the most talented sports professionals must undergo many years of training to develop the skills and fitness required, and this takes great commitment, dedication and passion. 其次，即使是最有天赋的体育专业人员也必须经过多年的训练来培养所需的技能和体能，这需要巨大的投入、奉献和热情。
- Finally, sports salaries are only high because audiences and fans are willing to pay to watch their favourite stars. 最后，体育界的薪水之所以高，只是因为观众和球迷愿意付费观看他们喜爱的明星。
- Note: The main reason why these two paragraphs are good is that we planned them carefully. We spent time thinking about the question, making notes, and organising our ideas in a logical way. 注意：这两个段落之所以优秀的主要是因为我们进行了仔细的规划。我们花时间思考题目，做笔记，并以逻辑严密的方式组织我们的想法。

IELTS Writing Task 2: two common mistakes

雅思写作任务 2：两个常见错误

- Here are two mistakes that students often make: 以下是学生经常犯的两个错误：
 - Using "although" wrongly (错误地使用 "although")
 - Always putting a comma after "that" (总是习惯在 "that" 后面加逗号)
- Look at these incorrect sentences (查看以下错误例句):
 1. Although, tourism has many benefits, but it also has some drawbacks. (错误: although 与 but 重复使用, 以及逗号位置错误)
 2. Many people believe that, parents should be strict. (错误: that 后面不加逗号)
- Now look at the correct sentences (查看正确例句):
 1. Although tourism has many benefits, it also has some drawbacks. (虽然旅游业有很多好处, 但它也有一些缺点。)
 2. Many people believe that parents should be strict. (许多人认为父母应该严格。)

IELTS Writing Task 2: ways to prepare

雅思写作任务 2: 备考方式

- Many students only do one thing to prepare for writing task 2: they write lots of full essays. 许多学生在备考任务 2 时只做一件事: 写大量的完整短文。
- Although it's obviously important to practise writing full essays, there are other things that I think you should be doing. 虽然练习写全文显然很重要, 但我认为你还应该做其他事情。
- Here are some study ideas for writing task 2: 以下是任务 2 的一些学习思路:
 1. Break the task into parts (拆分任务)
 - Instead of writing a full essay today, why not try writing 5 different introductions using my 2-sentence technique? 与其今天写一篇完整的短文, 不如尝试使用我的“两句话技巧”写 5 个不同的开头段?
 - Or challenge yourself to write 3 different main-body paragraphs about "advantages" (e.g. advantages of mobile phones, homeschooling and immigration) - use this lesson to help you. 或者挑战自己写 3 个不同的关于“优点”的正文主体段 (例如手机、居家教育和移民的优点) ——参考这节课来帮助你。
 - Or write 5 different conclusions - just one sentence each, summarising your response to 5 different questions. 或者写 5 个不同的结尾段——每个只需一句话, 总结你对 5 个不同问题的回答。
 1. Do some research (进行背景研究)
 - Instead of worrying about one particular question, try to find 10 recent exam questions (maybe using this page). 与其担心某一个具体的问题, 不如尝试找 10 个最近的考试题目 (也许利用这个页面)。
 - Write the questions on a piece of paper, decide what the general topic is for each one (e.g. advertising, prisons, life expectancy) and do some research about those topics. 把这些问题写在纸上, 确定每个问题的宏观主题是什么 (例如广告、监狱、预期寿命), 并对这些主题进行一些背景研

究。

- Don't worry about the exact question, just try to "collect" good ideas and vocabulary for the overall topic. 不要过于担心具体的提问，只需尝试为该宏观话题“收集”好想法和好词汇。
 - A quick search on Google or Wikipedia should give you what you need. 在谷歌或维基百科上快速搜索就能提供你所需的内容。
1. What do you believe? (确立你自己的信念/立场)
- A big problem for some students is that they don't have well-formed opinions. 对一些学生来说，一个大问题是他们没有形成成熟的观点。
 - They're not sure what to write about topics like homeschooling, immigration or gun control. 他们不确定在面对诸如居家教育、移民或枪支管控等话题时写些什么。
 - The good news is that there is no 'correct' opinion - the examiner is only looking at how well you express your opinions in English. 好消息是没有什么所谓的“正确”观点——考官只看你用英语表达自己观点的能力有多好。
 - So, after doing some research (see point 2 above), make sure you have an opinion of your own. 因此，在进行了一些研究之后（见上面的第 2 点），请确保你有自己的观点。

IELTS Writing Task 2: problem/solution essay

雅思写作任务 2：“问题与解决方案”范文

- In the developed world, average life expectancy is increasing. What problems will this cause for individuals and society? Suggest some measures that could be taken to reduce the impact of ageing populations. 在发达国家，平均预期寿命正在增加。这会给个人和社会带来什么问题？请提出一些可以采取的措施，以减轻人口老龄化的影响。
- It is true that people in industrialised nations can expect to live longer than ever before. 诚然，工业化国家的人们可以期望比以往活得更久。
- Although there will undoubtedly be some negative consequences of this trend, societies can take steps to mitigate these potential problems. 尽管这一趋势无疑会带来一些负面后果，但社会可以采取步骤来减轻这些潜在的问题。
- As people live longer and the populations of developed countries grow older, several related problems can be anticipated. 随着人们寿命延长以及发达国家人口日益老龄化，可以预见到几个相关的问题。
- The main issue is that there will obviously be more people of retirement age who will be eligible to receive a pension. 主要问题是，显然将有更多有资格领取养老金的退休年龄人口。
- The proportion of younger, working adults will be smaller, and governments will therefore receive less money in taxes in relation to the size of the population. 年轻的劳动适龄成人的比例将变小，因此政府相对于人口规模收到的税款将变少。
- In other words, an ageing population will mean a greater tax burden for working adults. 换句话说，人口老龄化将意味着在职成人的税收负担更大。
- Further pressures will include a rise in the demand for healthcare, and the fact young adults will

increasingly have to look after their elderly relatives. 进一步的压力将包括医疗保健需求的增加，以及年轻人将越来越不得不照顾他们年长亲属的事实。

- There are several actions that governments could take to solve the problems described above. 政府可以采取几项行动来解决上述问题。
- Firstly, a simple solution would be to increase the retirement age for working adults, perhaps from 65 to 70. 首先，一个简单的解决方案是提高在职成人的退休年龄，比如从 65 岁提高到 70 岁。
- Nowadays, people of this age tend to be healthy enough to continue a productive working life. 如今，这个年龄段的人往往足够健康，可以继续从事富有成效的工作生活。
- A second measure would be for governments to encourage immigration in order to increase the number of working adults who pay taxes. 第二项措施是政府鼓励移民，以增加缴纳税款的劳动成人的数量。
- Finally, money from national budgets will need to be taken from other areas and spent on vital healthcare, accommodation and transport facilities for the rising numbers of older citizens. 最后，需要从其他领域调拨国家预算资金，用于为日益增加的老年公民提供至关重要的医疗、住房和交通设施。
- In conclusion, various measures can be taken to tackle the problems that are certain to arise as the populations of countries grow older. 总之，随着各国人口老龄化，可以采取各种措施来解决必然会出现的问题。
- (265 words, band 9) (265 字，9 分范文)

IELTS Writing Task 2: from plan to paragraph

雅思写作任务 2：从计划到段落

- Let's try writing a full paragraph using the essay plan from this lesson. 让我们尝试使用本课的文章计划写一个完整的段落。
- The topic of this paragraph is "the problems caused by increasing life expectancy". 本段的主题是“预期寿命延长所带来的问题”。
- Here's the plan I wrote: 这是我写的计划：
 - Problems (问题):
 - an increase in the number of retired people who will receive a pension (将领取养老金的退休人员数量增加)
 - a smaller proportion of young adults = smaller working populations (年轻成人的比例变小 = 劳动人口变小)
 - a greater tax burden on working adults (在职成人的税负更大)
 - demand for healthcare will rise (医疗需求将上升)
 - young adults will have to look after elderly relatives (年轻人将不得不照顾年长的亲属)
- Here's my paragraph using the ideas above: 以下是利用上述观点写的段落：
- As people live longer and the populations of developed countries grow older, several related problems can be anticipated. 随着人们寿命延长以及发达国家人口日益老龄化，可以预见到几个相关的问题。

- The main issue is that there will obviously be more people of retirement age who will be eligible to receive a pension. 主要问题是，显然将有更多有资格领取养老金的退休年龄人口。
- The proportion of younger, working adults will be smaller, and governments will therefore receive less money in taxes in relation to the size of the population. 年轻的劳动适龄成人的比例将变小，因此政府相对于人口规模收到的税款将变少。
- In other words, an ageing population will mean a greater tax burden for working adults. 换句话说，人口老龄化将意味着在职成人的税收负担更大。
- Further pressures will include a rise in the demand for healthcare, and the fact young adults will increasingly have to look after their elderly relatives. 进一步的压力将包括医疗保健需求的增加，以及年轻人将越来越不得不照顾他们年长亲属的事实。
- Note: It would be easy to write more by adding an example (such as healthcare costs like more hospital beds and medical staff), but I've already written 106 words, which is enough for one main paragraph. 注意：通过增加例子（例如医疗费用加剧，如需要更多病床和医护人员）很容易写得更多，但我已经写了 106 个字，这对于一个主体段来说已经足够了。

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'ageing population' topic

雅思写作任务 2：“人口老龄化”话题

- In the developed world, average life expectancy is increasing. What problems will this cause for individuals and society? Suggest some measures that could be taken to reduce the impact of ageing populations. 在发达国家，平均预期寿命正在增加。这会给个人和社会带来什么问题？请提出一些可以采取的措施，以减轻人口老龄化的影响。
- Some advice (一些建议):
 - Write 4 paragraphs: introduction, problems, solutions, conclusion. 写 4 个段落：开头段、问题段、解决方案段、结尾段。
 - You don't need to separate ideas about individuals and ideas about society. Just mention something about both in your paragraphs. 你不需要把关于个人的想法和关于社会的想法分开。只需在你的段落中提及这两方面的内容即可。
- Some ideas (一些点子):
 - Problems (问题):
 - an increase in the number of retired people who will receive a pension (将领取养老金的退休人员数量增加)
 - a smaller proportion of young adults = smaller working populations (年轻成人的比例变小 = 劳动人口变小)
 - a greater tax burden on working adults (在职成人的税负更大)
 - demand for healthcare will rise (医疗需求将上升)
 - young adults will have to look after elderly relatives (年轻人将不得不照顾年长的亲属)
 - Solutions (解决方案):

- people may have to retire later; the state pension age will rise (人们可能不得不延迟退休；国家法定退休年龄将上升)
- medical advances and health programmes might allow elderly people to stay healthy and work for longer (医学进步和健康项目可能允许老年人保持健康并工作更长时间)
- people should be encouraged to have more children (应该鼓励人们多生孩子)
- governments could encourage immigration (in order to increase the number of younger adults) (政府可以鼓励移民 (以增加较年轻成人的数量))

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'capital punishment' topic

雅思写作任务 2：“死刑”话题

- Here are some ideas from my ebook about the topic of capital punishment. 以下是我电子书中关于死刑话题的一些观点。
- Remember that you won't be able to write a good essay unless you have good ideas. 记住，除非你有好的观点，否则你写不出一篇好文章。
- Also, you should always try to prepare both sides of the argument. 此外，你始终应该尝试准备论点的正反双方。
- Arguments for capital punishment (支持死刑的论点):
 - Supporters say that capital punishment deters crime. 支持者表示，死刑能震慑犯罪。
 - Fear of the death penalty stops people from committing offences. 对死刑的恐惧阻止了人们犯罪。
 - The death penalty shows that crime is not tolerated. 死刑表明犯罪是绝不可姑息容忍的。
 - It is a form of revenge. 这是一种复仇的形式。
 - The cost of imprisonment is avoided. 避免了监禁的成本支出。
 - The offender cannot pose a threat to others. 罪犯无法再对他人构成威胁。
- Arguments against capital punishment (反对死刑的论点):
 - Innocent people could be wrongly convicted and executed. 无辜的人可能会被错判并处决。
 - Crime rates are not necessarily reduced. 犯罪率并不一定会因此降低。
 - Many criminals do not think they will be caught. 许多犯罪分子并不认为自己会被抓获。
 - Capital punishment is not a good deterrent. 死刑并不是一个很好的威慑手段。
 - Executing prisoners creates a violent culture and encourages revenge. 处决犯人会制造暴力文化并助长复仇风气。
 - We have no right to take another human life. 我们无权剥夺另一个人的生命。

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'petrol price' introduction

雅思写作任务 2：“汽油价格”开头段

- The following question comes from Cambridge IELTS book 8. 以下问题来自剑桥雅思第 8 册。

- Increasing the price of petrol is the best way to solve growing traffic and pollution problems. To what extent do you agree or disagree? What other measures do you think might be effective? 提高汽油价格是解决日益严重的交通和污染问题的最佳途径。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？你认为还有哪些其他措施可能是有效的？
- My students wrote the introduction below. 我的学生写了下面的开头段。
- Notice that it addresses all parts of the question so that the examiner knows exactly what our position is. 注意它回应了问题的各个部分，从而让考官确切知道我们的立场。
- Traffic and pollution are growing problems in today's society. 交通和污染是当今社会日益严重的问题。
- Personally, I disagree with the idea that higher petrol prices could solve these problems, and I believe that various other measures would be more constructive. 就个人而言，我不同意较高的汽油价格可以解决这些问题的观点，我认为各种其他措施会更有建设性。
- PS. Don't waste time writing a longer introduction than this. The main body paragraphs are much more important! 顺便说一句，不要浪费时间写比这更长的开头段了。正文主体段要重要得多！

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'video games' essay

雅思写作任务 2：“电子游戏”范文

- Some people regard video games as harmless fun, or even as a useful educational tool. Others, however, believe that video games are having an adverse effect on the people who play them. In your opinion, do the drawbacks of video games outweigh the benefits? 有些人认为电子游戏是无害的娱乐，甚至是有用的教育工具。然而，另一些人认为电子游戏正在对玩家产生不利影响。在你看来，电子游戏的缺点大于优点吗？
- Many people, and children in particular, enjoy playing computer games. 许多人，特别是儿童，喜欢玩电脑游戏。
- While I accept that these games can sometimes have a positive effect on the user, I believe that they are more likely to have a harmful impact. 虽然我承认这些游戏有时会对使用者产生积极影响，但认为它们更有可能产生有害影响。
- On the one hand, video games can be both entertaining and educational. 一方面，电子游戏既可以具有娱乐性，也可以具有教育意义。
- Users, or gamers, are transported into virtual worlds which are often more exciting and engaging than real-life pastimes. 用户或玩家被带入虚拟世界，这些世界通常比现实生活中的消遣活动更令人兴奋和引人入胜。
- From an educational perspective, these games encourage imagination and creativity, as well as concentration, logical thinking and problem solving, all of which are useful skills outside the gaming context. 从教育的角度来看，这些游戏鼓励想象力和创造力，以及专注力、逻辑思维和解决问题的能力，所有这些都是游戏环境之外的有用技能。
- Furthermore, it has been shown that computer simulation games can improve users' motor skills and help to prepare them for real-world tasks, such as flying a plane. 此外，事实表明，计算机模拟游戏可以提高用户的运动技巧，并有助于他们为现实世界中的任务（如开飞机）做好准备。

- However, I would argue that these benefits are outweighed by the drawbacks. 然而，我认为这些优点被缺点所抵消/缺点大于优点。
- Gaming can be highly addictive because users are constantly given scores, new targets and frequent rewards to keep them playing. 游戏可能会高度令人上瘾，因为玩家不断获得分数、新目标和频繁的奖励，以保持他们继续玩下去。
- Many children now spend hours each day trying to progress through the levels of a game or to get a higher score than their friends. 许多孩子现在每天花几个小时试图在游戏关卡中晋级，或者获得比朋友更高的分数。
- This type of addiction can have effects ranging from lack of sleep to problems at school, when homework is sacrificed for a few more hours on the computer or console. 这种上瘾的影响范围从缺乏睡眠到学校问题不等，因为为了在电脑或游戏机上多玩几个小时而牺牲了家庭作业。
- The rise in obesity in recent years has also been linked in part to the sedentary lifestyle and lack of exercise that often accompany gaming addiction. 近年来肥胖率的上升在一定程度上也与经常伴随游戏成瘾而来的久坐不动的生活方式和缺乏运动有关。
- In conclusion, it seems to me that the potential dangers of video games are more significant than the possible benefits. 总之，在我看来，电子游戏的潜在危险比可能的好处更为显著。
- (258 words, band 9) (258 字，9 分范文)

IELTS Writing Task 2: are you stuck?

雅思写作任务 2：你陷入瓶颈了吗？

- Students often tell me that they are stuck on the same writing score. 学生经常告诉我，他们的写作分数卡在同一个分数上。
- For example, they keep getting 6.5 in every test they take. 例如，他们每次考试总是拿到 6.5 分。
- If you are stuck in a rut like this, perhaps the most effective way to get out of it is to give more importance to your essay plan. 如果你陷入了这种死胡同，也许走出困境最有效的方法就是更加重视你的文章计划。
- I tell my students to spend around 3 minutes making notes for each main body paragraph. 我告诉我的学生花大约 3 分钟时间为每个正文主体段做笔记。
- So, for the housing topic we've been looking at recently, we would spend 3 minutes thinking about why we shouldn't build more houses in cities, and 3 more minutes thinking about the benefits of developing new towns. 因此，对于我们最近一直在研究的住房话题，我们会花 3 分钟思考为什么我们不应该在城市建造更多的房屋，然后再花 3 分钟思考建设新城镇的好处。
- The act of planning helps you to separate the task of idea generation from the task of writing. 制定计划这一行为有助于你将“生成观点”的任务与“写作”的任务分离开来。
- It's extremely difficult to do both of these things at the same time. 同时做这两件事是非常困难的。

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'music' essay

雅思写作任务 2：“音乐”范文

- There are many different types of music in the world today. Why do we need music? Is the traditional music of a country more important than the international music that is heard everywhere nowadays? 当今世界有许多不同类型的音乐。我们为什么需要音乐？一个国家的传统音乐比如今到处都能听到的国际音乐更重要吗？
- It is true that a rich variety of musical styles can be found around the world. 诚然，在世界各地都可以找到丰富多样的音乐风格。
- Music is a vital part of all human cultures for a range of reasons, and I would argue that traditional music is more important than modern, international music. 出于一系列原因，音乐是所有人类文化中至关重要的一部分，我认为传统音乐比现代国际音乐更重要。
- Music is something that accompanies all of us throughout our lives. 音乐是陪伴我们所有人一生的东西。
- As children, we are taught songs by our parents and teachers as a means of learning language, or simply as a form of enjoyment. 小时候，父母和老师教我们唱歌，作为学习语言的一种手段，或者仅仅作为一种娱乐形式。
- Children delight in singing with others, and it would appear that the act of singing in a group creates a connection between participants, regardless of their age. 孩子们喜欢与他人合唱，而且集体唱歌这一行为似乎可以在参与者之间建立联系，无论他们的年龄大小。
- Later in life, people's musical preferences develop, and we come to see our favourite songs as part of our life stories. 在以后的生活中，人们对音乐的偏好逐渐形成，我们开始把喜爱的歌曲视为我们人生故事的一部分。
- Music both expresses and arouses emotions in a way that words alone cannot. 音乐以仅靠文字无法做到的方式表达和唤起情感。
- In short, it is difficult to imagine life without it. 简而言之，很难想象没有音乐的生活。
- In my opinion, traditional music should be valued over the international music that has become so popular. 在我看来，传统音乐应该比如今大受欢迎的国际音乐受到更多的重视。
- International pop music is often catchy and fun, but it is essentially a commercial product that is marketed and sold by business people. 国际流行音乐通常朗朗上口且有趣，但它本质上是一种由商人营销和销售的商业产品。
- Traditional music, by contrast, expresses the culture, customs and history of a country. 相比之下，传统音乐表达了一个国家的文化、习俗和历史。
- Traditional styles, such as ...(example)..., connect us to the past and form part of our cultural identity. 传统风格（如：.....示例.....）将我们与过去联系起来，并构成我们文化身份的一部分。
- It would be a real pity if pop music became so predominant that these national styles disappeared. 如果流行音乐变得如此主导，以至于这些民族风格消失了，那将是非常遗憾的事。
- In conclusion, music is a necessary part of human existence, and I believe that traditional music should be given more importance than international music. 总之，音乐是人类生存所必需的一部分，我认为应该给予传统音乐比国际音乐更多的重要性。
- (261 words, band 9) (261 字，9 分范文)

IELTS Writing Task 2: correct the mistakes

雅思写作任务 2：改错练习

- Several people tried writing about the music topic in last week's lesson. 有几个人尝试写了上周课程中的音乐话题。
 - Try to correct the mistakes that they made in the sentences below. 请尝试纠正他们在本页句子中所犯的错误。
 - I'll share my full essay next week. 我下周会分享我的完整范文。
1. We have different types of music all over the world, we need music for various reasons. (标点错误/连体句)
 2. The first I think we need music almost for enjoyment. (表达不地道/语法混乱)
 3. People listening to a variety of music is due to a number of reasons. (主谓搭配不当/语病)
 4. It is clear cut evidence why we need for music. (介词多余/结构不当)
 5. Traditional music of a country has more weight that the famous international music. (拼写/用词错误: that 应为 than)
 6. At a glance, we need music for enjoyment. (误用短语: At a glance 意为“一眼看去”，在此语境不适用)
 7. The people is more happier listening all kind the rhythms and sounds than without it. (主谓一致及比较级错误)
 8. It helps to make relaxed from any sort of strain. (缺少宾语/动词搭配不当)
 9. If the international music would replace it then the whole historical experience of a country will die. (虚拟语气/条件状语从句时态错误)

IELTS Writing Task 2: answer all parts of the question

雅思写作任务 2：完整回答问题的各个部分

- A student sent me the following question: 一个学生给我发了以下问题：
- The role of prisons should be to punish criminals who have committed serious crimes. Training courses and education offered to prisoners are a waste of taxpayer's money. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 监狱的作用应该是惩罚犯下严重罪行的罪犯。为囚犯提供的培训课程和教育是对纳税人资金的浪费。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？
- The student who sent me this question noticed that it contains two sub-topics: 发送给我这个问题的学生注意到它包含两个子话题：
 1. Should the role of prisons be to punish serious criminals, not petty criminals (less serious criminals)?
 1. 监狱的作用应该是惩罚重罪犯，而不是轻罪犯（不太严重的罪犯）吗？
 2. Are training courses and education a waste of money? 2. 培训课程和教育是浪费钱吗？
- Apparently there is a model essay for this question which only addresses the second sub-topic. 显然，针

对这个问题有一篇范文只回应了第二个子话题。

- I think that would be a mistake; you should try to answer all parts of the question. 我认为那将是一个错误；你应该尝试回答问题的各个部分。
- In this case, the two sub-topics help you because they tell you what you should write about in your two main body paragraphs. 在这种情况下，这两个子话题对你有帮助，因为它们告诉了你在两个正文主体段中应该写些什么。
- Always study the question carefully, and make sure you know exactly what it is asking you to do! 一定要仔细审题，确保你确切知道它要求你做什么！

IELTS Writing Task 2: the 10-minute plan

雅思写作任务 2：10 分钟规划法

- If you are struggling to improve your score for writing task 2, the solution might be to spend more time planning before you start writing. 如果你正苦苦挣扎于提升任务 2 的分数，解决方案可能是在动笔写作前花更多的时间进行规划。
- I asked the students on my most recent one-day course to spend 10 minutes planning a question about whether the only purpose of prisons is to punish people. 在我最近的单日课程中，我让学生们花 10 分钟时间规划一个关于“监狱的唯一目的是否是惩罚人”的问题。
- Here are the ideas that my students had: 以下是我的学生们想出的观点：
- Paragraph 2: prisons do punish offenders (第 2 段：监狱确实惩罚罪犯)
 - Punishment makes offenders think, reflect, feel sorry, understand the consequences (that we have choices about the actions we take), suffering, revenge / justice for victims, debt to society, taking away freedom and privileges, miss family, deter people from committing crimes in future - fear of prison 惩罚让罪犯思考、反省、感到悔恨、理解后果（我们的行为是由自己选择的）、痛苦、为受害者复仇/伸张正义、还清对社会的欠债、剥夺自由和特权、想念家人、震慑人们未来不再犯罪——对监狱的恐惧
- Paragraph 3: other purposes of prisons (第 3 段：监狱的其他目的)
 - Reflection time, rehabilitation - help the prisoner to prepare for normal life: new skills, education, courses, qualifications, treatment - reform, reeducate, find employment, re-enter society - address the root causes of crime 反思时间、改造/康复——帮助囚犯为正常生活做准备：新技能、教育、课程、资质认证、治疗——改造、重新教育、寻找工作、重新融入社会——解决犯罪的根本原因
- With a plan like this, you should find it easier to write a great essay. 有了这样的计划，你应该会发现写出一篇优秀的文章变得更容易。

IELTS Writing Task 2: advantages and disadvantages

雅思写作任务 2：利弊分析

- Albert sent me this recent exam question: Albert 给我发了最近的这道考题：
- In many countries nowadays, young single people no longer stay with their parents until they are married, but leave to study or work somewhere else. Do you think this trend has more advantages or

disadvantages? 如今在许多国家，年轻单身人士不再与父母同住直到结婚，而是离开家去其他地方学习或工作。你认为这种趋势是利大于弊还是弊大于利？

- Here are some tips to help with this kind of question: 以下是帮助解决此类问题的一些技巧：
 1. Notice that the question includes the words "do you think". This tells you that you need to give your own opinion, as well as discussing both the advantages and disadvantages. Put your opinion in the introduction and conclusion, and don't be afraid to use the word "I" (e.g. I believe) to make it clear what you think. 注意问题中包含了“do you think（你认为）”这些词。这告诉你，除了讨论优点和缺点外，你还需要给出自己的观点。把你的观点放在开头段和结尾段中，不要害怕使用“I”（如 I believe）这个词来明确表达你的想法。
 2. You won't be able to write a good essay if you don't plan your ideas first. Spend 2-3 minutes noting down ideas for the advantages of leaving home before marriage, then 2-3 minutes writing notes for the disadvantages. Then decide what your opinion is, according to whether you have more advantages or disadvantages. 如果你不先规划你的想法，你就写不出好文章。花 2-3 分钟记录婚前离家的优点，然后花 2-3 分钟记录缺点。然后根据你的优点多还是缺点多来决定你的观点是什么。
 3. If you can't think of any ideas, start by thinking of some examples e.g. Did you or any of your friends leave home before getting married? Do you know anyone who lived with their parents until they got married? What were the reasons and benefits or drawbacks of each decision? 如果你想不到任何想法，先从想一些例子开始，例如：你或你的朋友中有没有人在结婚前搬离家？你认识一直和父母住在一起直到结婚的人吗？每个决定的原因、好处或弊端是什么？
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (56) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (56)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'discussion' introduction

雅思写作任务 2：“讨论”类开头段

- Wednesday, August 01, 2012 2012年8月1日，星期三
- Last week we looked at a 'problem and solution' introduction. 上周我们看了一个“问题与解决方案”的开头段。
- Today I'll use the same technique (2 sentences: topic + basic answer) to write a 'discussion and opinion' introduction. 今天我将使用相同的技巧（2 句话：主题 + 基本回答）来写一个“讨论与观点”类的开头段。
- Here's a question (from Cambridge IELTS 6): 这是一个题目（来自剑桥雅思 6）：
- Successful sports professionals can earn a great deal more money than people in other important professions. Some people think this is fully justified while others think it is unfair. Discuss both these views and give your own opinion. 成功的体育专业人员可以比其他重要领域的专业人员赚多得多的钱。有些人认为这完全合理，而另一些人则认为这不公平。讨论这两种观点并给出你自己的意见。
- Here's my 2-sentence introduction: 这是我的两句话开头段：
- It is true that sports stars often earn huge salaries. 诚然，体育明星往往赚取巨额薪水。
- While there are some good reasons why this is the case, I personally believe that it is wrong for these people to be paid more than other professionals. 虽然有一些充分的理由可以解释为什么会这样，但我个人

认为，这些人比其他专业人士获得更高的薪酬是错误的。

- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (28) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (28)

IELTS Writing Task 2: problem & solution introduction

雅思写作任务 2：问题与解决方案类开头段

- Wednesday, July 25, 2012 2012年7月25日，星期三
- My advice for task 2 introductions is to write them very quickly. 我对任务 2 开头段的建议是写得要非常迅速。
- Just write 2 sentences: one to introduce the topic, and one to give a basic answer. 只需写 2 句话：一句引入主题，一句给出基本回答。
- Let's look at how to do this for a "problem and solution" question: 让我们看看如何为“问题与解决方案”类题目做到这一点：
- The number of plants and animals is declining. Describe some reasons for this problem and suggest some solutions. 动植物的数量正在下降。描述该问题的一些原因并提出一些解决方案。
- Here's my introduction: 这是我的开头段：
- It is undeniable that wildlife habitats are being destroyed and whole species of plants and animals are disappearing. 不可否认，野生动物的栖息地正在遭受破坏，整类动植物物种正在消失。
- There are several causes of this alarming trend, but measures could certainly be taken to tackle the problem. 这种令人担忧的趋势有几个原因，但完全可以采取措施来解决这个问题。
- Note: In the second sentence you don't need to give any causes or solutions; save your ideas for the main paragraphs. 注意：在第二句话中，你不需要给出任何具体原因或解决方案；将你的观点留给主体段落。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (22) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (22)

IELTS Writing Task 2: idea and paragraph

雅思写作任务 2：观点与段落生成

- Wednesday, July 18, 2012 2012年7月18日，星期三
- My students and I followed the advice in last week's lesson to write a paragraph for the topic below. 我和我的学生遵循上周课程的建议，为以下话题写了一个段落。
- The number of plants and animals is declining. Describe the problem and suggest some solutions. 动植物的数量正在下降。描述该问题并提出一些解决方案。
- Ideas for describing the problem (描述问题的观点):
 - over-farming, land needed for crops and animals (过度耕作，农作物和牲畜所需的土地)
 - cutting down trees destroys natural habitats, animals become extinct (砍伐树木破坏了自然栖息地，动物灭绝)

- industrial waste in rivers, sea (河流、海洋中的工业废弃物)
- chemicals kill fish and plants, interrupt natural cycles / food chain (化学物质杀死鱼类和植物，中断自然循环/食物链)
- It seemed that we had 2 main ideas, so we wrote a 2-idea paragraph: 看起来我们有两个主要观点，因此我们写了一个双观点的段落：
- There are two main reasons why plants and animals are disappearing. 动植物消失有两个主要原因。
- Firstly, in many parts of the world trees are being cut down to make way for farmland on which to grow crops and keep animals. 首先，在世界许多地方，树木被砍伐以让位给种植农作物和饲养牲畜的农田。
- The result of this is that natural habitats are being destroyed, and in some cases whole species of animals are becoming extinct. 这样做的后果是自然栖息地遭受破坏，在某些情况下整类动物物种正在灭绝。
- Secondly, human activity is also responsible for the destruction of aquatic life as domestic and industrial waste is pumped into rivers and seas. 其次，由于生活和工业废弃物被排入江河湖海，人类活动也是水生生物遭到破坏的原因。
- This chemical waste kills plants and fish, interrupting natural cycles and having a devastating effect on food chains. 这种化学废弃物杀死了植物和鱼类，中断了自然循环，对食物链产生了毁灭性的影响。
- (99 words) (99 字)
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (35) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (35)

IELTS Writing Task 2: from ideas to paragraph

雅思写作任务 2：从观点到段落

- Wednesday, July 11, 2012 2012年7月11日，星期三
- I always tell my students to plan ideas for their main body paragraphs. 我总是告诉我的学生要为他们的正文主体段规划观点。
- Let's look at how to put some ideas together to make a paragraph. 让我们看看如何将一些观点组合在一起组成一个段落。
- Here's the question: 这是题目：
- The main reason people go to work is to earn money. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 人们去工作的主要原因是赚钱。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？
- Ideas for one main paragraph (一个主体段的观点)：
 - agree that money is the main reason people work (同意金钱是人们工作的主要原因)
 - people look at salary first, they rarely take a salary cut (人们首先看薪水，他们很少接受降薪)
 - need to live, pay bills, food etc. (需要生活、付账单、买食物等)
 - look after our families, save for the future (照顾我们的家庭，为未来储蓄)
 - otherwise, most people would probably choose not to work (否则，大多数人可能会选择不工作)

- Full paragraph using the ideas above: 使用上述观点完成的完整段落：
- I agree that the majority of people work in order to earn money. 我同意大多数人工作是为了赚钱。
- Before taking any other factors into account, it is normal to first consider the salary that a particular post offers, and it is rare to hear of a person who happily takes a cut in pay when beginning a new job. 在考虑任何其他因素之前，首先考虑特定岗位提供的薪水是正常的，并且很少听说有人在开始新工作时乐意接受降薪。
- We all need money to pay for our basic necessities, such as accommodation, bills and food. 我们都需要钱来支付我们的基本生活必需品，如住宿、账单和食物。
- Many adults also have families who depend on the wages they earn, and at the same time they are conscious of the need to save for the future. 许多成年人也有依靠他们赚取的工资维生的家庭，同时他们也意识到了为未来储蓄的必要性。
- If we no longer needed money, I doubt most of us would choose to continue in our jobs. 如果我们不再需要钱，我怀疑我们中的大多数人是否还会选择继续工作。
- (116 words) (116 字)
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | [Permalink](#) | [Comments \(30\)](#) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | [永久链接](#) | [评论 \(30\)](#)

IELTS Writing Task 2: before you start writing

雅思写作任务 2：动笔前的准备

- Wednesday, July 04, 2012 2012年7月4日，星期三
- Before you start writing your task 2 essay, you need to do two things: 在你开始写任务 2 的文章之前，你需要做两件事：
 1. Plan your overall essay structure (ideally 4 paragraphs) 规划文章的整体结构（理想情况下为 4 个段落）
 2. Spend some time thinking of ideas for the main body paragraphs 花些时间构思正文主体段的观点
- Here are two recent exam questions that you could try writing a plan for: 以下是你可以尝试为其编写计划的两个最近的考题：
- The main reason people go to work is to earn money. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 人们去工作的主要原因是赚钱。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？
- Many people prefer to rent a house rather than buying one. Describe the advantages and disadvantages of renting. 许多人喜欢租房而不是买房。描述租房的优点和缺点。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | [Permalink](#) | [Comments \(35\)](#) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | [永久链接](#) | [评论 \(35\)](#)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'unpaid work' essay

雅思写作任务 2：“无偿工作/无偿社区服务”范文

- Wednesday, June 27, 2012 2012年6月27日, 星期三
- Some people think that all teenagers should be required to do unpaid work in their free time to help the local community. They believe this would benefit both the individual teenager and society as a whole. Do you agree or disagree? 有些人认为应该要求所有青少年在空闲时间做无偿工作来帮助当地社区。他们认为这将造福青少年个人和整个社会。你同意还是不同意?
- Many young people work on a volunteer basis, and this can only be beneficial for both the individual and society as a whole. 许多年轻人以志愿者的形式工作, 这对个人和整个社会来说都只会好处。
- However, I do not agree that we should therefore force all teenagers to do unpaid work. 然而, 我不同意我们因此应该强迫所有青少年去做无偿工作。
- Most young people are already under enough pressure with their studies, without being given the added responsibility of working in their spare time. 大多数年轻人已经在学习上面临着足够的压力, 不需要再在课余时间被给予额外的工作责任。
- School is just as demanding as a full-time job, and teachers expect their students to do homework and exam revision on top of attending lessons every day. 学校和全职工作一样要求严格, 老师们除了每天上课外, 还期望学生做作业和复习备考。
- When young people do have some free time, we should encourage them to enjoy it with their friends or to spend it doing sports and other leisure activities. 当年轻人确实有一些空闲时间时, 我们应该鼓励他们与朋友一起享受空闲时间, 或者花时间进行体育运动和其他休闲活动。
- They have many years of work ahead of them when they finish their studies. 他们在完成学业后, 未来还有多年的工作路要走。
- At the same time, I do not believe that society has anything to gain from obliging young people to do unpaid work. 同时, 我不认为社会能从强迫年轻人做无偿工作中获得任何好处。
- In fact, I would argue that it goes against the values of a free and fair society to force a group of people to do something against their will. 事实上, 我认为强迫一组人违背其意愿去做某事违背了自由公平社会的价值观。
- Doing this can only lead to resentment amongst young people, who would feel that they were being used, and parents, who would not want to be told how to raise their children. 这样做只会引发感觉自己被利用的青少年的怨恨, 以及不希望被告知如何抚养孩子的父母的不满。
- Currently, nobody is forced to volunteer, and this is surely the best system. 目前, 没有人被强迫去做志愿者, 这无疑是最好的制度。
- In conclusion, teenagers may choose to work for free and help others, but in my opinion we should not make this compulsory. 总之, 青少年可以选择无偿工作并帮助他人, 但在我看来, 我们不应该将其定为强制性的。
- (250 words, band 9) (250 字, 9 分范文)
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | [Permalink](#) | [Comments \(33\)](#) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | [永久链接](#) | [评论 \(33\)](#)

IELTS Writing Task 2: completely disagree

雅思写作任务 2：完全不同意

- Wednesday, June 20, 2012 2012年6月20日, 星期三
- When you completely agree or completely disagree with the question statement, you don't need to write about the other side of the argument. 当你完全同意或完全不同意题目的陈述时, 你不需要写论点的另一方。
- Just state your opinion and give reasons. 只需陈述你的观点并给出理由。
- Today I'll show you how to write a 'disagree' essay for this question: 今天我将向你们展示如何针对这个问题写一篇“不同意”的文章:
- Some people think that all teenagers should be required to do unpaid work in their free time to help the local community. They believe this would benefit both the individual teenager and society as a whole. Do you agree or disagree? 有些人认为应该要求所有青少年在空闲时间做无偿工作来帮助当地社区。他们认为这将造福青少年个人和整个社会。你同意还是不同意?
- Here's my 4-paragraph plan: 这是我的 4 段式规划:
 1. Introduction: introduce the topic of unpaid work for teenagers, and make it clear that you completely disagree with the idea of requiring (forcing) young people to do this. 开头段: 引入青少年无偿工作的话题, 并明确表达你完全不同意要求(强迫)年轻人这样做的想法。
 2. First reason: explain why this idea would not benefit teenagers e.g. they are already busy with school work, they should be allowed to enjoy being young, they have many years of work ahead of them when they finish their studies. 第一个原因: 解释为什么这个想法不会造福青少年, 例如: 他们已经忙于学业, 应该允许他们享受年轻时光, 他们在完成学业后还有多年的工作路要走。
 3. Second reason: explain why this idea would not benefit society e.g. forcing young people to work goes against the values of a free society, the current system of volunteering is better, this idea would be impossible to enforce. 第二个原因: 解释为什么这个想法不会造福社会, 例如: 强迫年轻人工作违背了自由社会的价值观, 目前的志愿服务制度更好, 这个想法不可能被强制实施。
 4. Conclusion: repeat your opinion that requiring teenagers to work benefits neither the teenagers nor society as a whole. 结尾段: 重复你的观点, 即要求青少年工作既无益于青少年本身, 也无益于整个社会。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (21) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (21)

IELTS Writing Task 2: fully respond to the question

雅思写作任务 2：充分回应问题

- Wednesday, June 13, 2012 2012年6月13日, 星期三
- One of the things that the examiner will check carefully is whether or not you have fully responded to the question. 考官会仔细检查的事情之一就是你是否充分回应了问题。
- Here's a question that a student sent me: 这是学生给我发的一个问题:
- Some people think that all teenagers should be required to do unpaid work in their free time to help the

local community. They believe this would benefit both the individual teenager and society as a whole. Do you agree or disagree? 有些人认为应该要求所有青少年在空闲时间做无偿工作来帮助当地社区。他们认为这将造福青少年个人和整个社会。你同意还是不同意？

- The student who sent me this question wrote about the advantages and disadvantages of unpaid work for teenagers, but completely forgot to mention the benefits and/or drawbacks for society as a whole. 给我发这个问题的学生写了青少年做无偿工作的优点和缺点，但完全忘记了提及对整个社会的好处和/或弊端。
- If you don't fully answer the question, it's extremely difficult to get a band 7. 如果你没有充分回答问题，极难拿到 7 分。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (27) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (27)

IELTS Writing Task 2: introduction without opinion

雅思写作任务 2：不带观点的开头段

- Wednesday, June 06, 2012 2012年6月6日，星期三
- My normal advice for task 2 introductions is this: write two sentences - one to introduce the essay topic, and one to give a basic answer to the question. 我对任务 2 开头段的常规建议是：写两句话——一句引入文章主题，一句对问题给出基本回答。
- But what should you put in the second sentence (basic answer) if the question doesn't ask for your opinion? 但是，如果题目没有询问你的观点，你该在第二句话（基本回答）中写些什么呢？
- Here are two example questions: 以下是两个示例题目：
 1. Many people believe that an effective public transport system is a key component of a modern city. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of public transport. 许多人认为有效的公共交通系统是现代城市的关键要素。讨论公共交通的优点和缺点。
 2. Crime rates tend to be higher in cities than in smaller towns. Explain some possible reasons for this problem, and suggest some solutions. 城市的犯罪率往往高于小城镇。解释该问题的一些可能原因，并提出一些解决方案。
- Here are two sample introductions: 以下是两个开头段范例：
 1. Officials in many cities are keen to develop efficient public transport systems. While public transport has many benefits, there are also some drawbacks which are worth considering. 许多城市的官员都渴望发展高效的公共交通系统。虽然公共交通有很多好处，但也有一些缺点值得考虑。
 2. Cities generally experience higher levels of criminality than towns or villages. There are various reasons for this, but measures could be taken to tackle the problem. 城市通常比城镇或村庄面临更高水平的犯罪活动。对此有各种各样的原因，但可以采取措施来解决这个问题。
- Hopefully you can see that it's quite easy to write an introduction for these types of question. 希望你能看到，为这些类型的问题写开头段是非常容易的。
- The approach is the same (topic + basic answer) whether the question asks for your opinion or not. 无论题目是否询问你的观点，方法都是相同的（主题 + 基本回答）。

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'food technology' topic

雅思写作任务 2: “食品科技”话题

- Here are some ideas for last week's topic. The ideas are adapted from the 'genetic engineering' chapter in my ebook. 以下是上周话题的一些观点。这些观点改编自我的电子书中的“基因工程”一章。
- The range and quality of food that we can buy has changed because of technological and scientific advances. Some people regard this change as an improvement, while others believe that it is harmful. Discuss both views and give your own opinion. 由于技术和科学的进步，我们可以买到的食品种类和质量发生了改变。有些人认为这种改变是一种进步，而另一些人则认为这是有害的。讨论两种观点并给出你自己的意见。
- Positives of advances in food technology (食品科技进步的积极方面):
 - Farmers can produce crops that grow bigger and faster. (农民可以生产长得更大、更快的农作物)
 - Genetically modified crops may be more resistant to disease or insects. (转基因作物可能对疾病或昆虫更有抵抗力)
 - This could be important for food production in developing countries. (这对于发展中国家的粮食生产可能很重要)
 - Faster growing cereals, fruit and vegetables will mean more profit. (生长更快的谷物、水果和蔬菜将意味着更多的利润)
 - Foods can be modified to look perfect and last longer. (食品经过改造可以看起来很完美且保存更久)
 - They may be more attractive to customers. (它们对客户可能更有吸引力)
- Negatives of advances in food technology (食品科技进步的消极方面):
 - Many people distrust foods that have been modified or processed. (许多人不信任经过改造或加工的食品)
 - They prefer organic foods which are produced without chemicals. (他们更喜欢不使用化学物质生产的有机食品)
 - Farming without fertilisers or pesticides is more environmentally friendly. (不使用化肥或农药的耕作对环境更友好)
 - There may be risks involved in the genetic engineering of foods. (食品的基因工程可能存在风险)
 - Genetically modified crops might change whole ecosystems. (转基因作物可能会改变整个生态系统)
 - Food chains could be broken if crops are resistant to predators. (如果农作物能够抵抗捕食者，食物链可能会断裂)
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | [Permalink](#) | [Comments \(40\)](#) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | [永久链接](#) | [评论 \(40\)](#)

IELTS Writing Task 2: the importance of planning

雅思写作任务 2: 规划的重要性

- Wednesday, May 23, 2012 2012年5月23日, 星期三
- When the question topic is difficult, planning becomes even more important. 当题目的话题困难时, 规划就变得更加重要了。
- If you start writing your essay straight away, without preparing some ideas first, you will probably get stuck and start to panic! 如果你在没有先准备好一些想法的情况下就直接开始动笔写作, 你可能会卡住并开始恐慌!
- Take this recent exam question: 以此近期的考题为例:
- The range and quality of food that we can buy has changed because of technological and scientific advances. Some people regard this change as an improvement, while others believe that it is harmful. Discuss both views and give your own opinion. 由于技术和科学的进步, 我们可以买到的食品种类和质量发生了改变。有些人认为这种改变是一种进步, 而另一些人则认为这是有害的。讨论两种观点并给出你自己的意见。
- I think you'll agree that this is a tricky question. 我想你会同意这是一个棘手的问题。
- My advice would be to spend about 10 minutes planning. 我的建议是花大约 10 分钟进行规划。
- Follow these steps before you start writing: 在你开始写作之前, 请遵循以下步骤:
 1. Take a couple of minutes to read and understand the question. 花几分钟阅读并理解题目。
 2. Decide what each of your 4 paragraphs should contain. 决定你的 4 个段落各自应该包含什么。
 3. Spend around 6 minutes noting down ideas for the two points of view. 花大约 6 分钟时间记录两种观点的想法。
- Click here to download an essay plan template that I use with my students. 点击这里下载我和学生一起使用的文章计划模板。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (44) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (44)

IELTS Writing Task 2: both sides or one side?

雅思写作任务 2: 写双方还是写单方?

- Wednesday, May 16, 2012 2012年5月16日, 星期三
- Can you see the difference between the two questions below? 你能看出下面这两个问题之间的区别吗?
 - A) Explain the positives and negatives of this development. (解释这种发展的积极和消极方面。)
 - B) Is this a positive or negative development? (这是一个积极的发展还是消极的发展?)
- and these two questions (以及这两个问题):
 - A) What are the advantages and disadvantages? (优点和缺点是什么?)
 - B) Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages? (优点大于缺点吗?)
- and these two questions (以及这两个问题):
 - A) Discuss both views and give your opinion. (讨论双方观点并给出你的意见。)

◦ B) To what extent do you agree or disagree? (你在多大程度上同意或不同意?)

- Answer (答案):
- The difference is that for all of the (A) questions you must explain both sides of the argument, whereas the (B) questions can be answered by giving both sides or by supporting only one side, depending on the view that you express in your introduction. 区别在于，对于所有 (A) 类问题，你必须解释论点的双方；而 (B) 类问题可以通过给出双方或仅支持一方来回答，这取决于你在开头段中表达的观点。
- This is still the most common confusion that students ask me about. 这仍然是学生向我询问的最常见的困惑。
- Make sure you understand the difference between the questions above; if you're still unsure, look through all of my task 2 lessons to see further advice and examples. 请确保你理解上述问题之间的区别；如果你仍不确定，请翻阅我所有的任务 2 课程，查看进一步的建议和示例。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (24) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (24)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'prisons' topic

雅思写作任务 2: “监狱”话题

- Wednesday, May 09, 2012 2012年5月9日，星期三
- In today's lesson I'll try to explain what makes a good paragraph. 在今天的课程中，我将尝试解释是什么构成了一个好的段落。
- We'll analyse a paragraph that I wrote with some of my students. 我们将分析我和一些学生一起写的段落。
- Paragraph about the purpose of prisons (关于监狱目的的段落):
- On the one hand, criminals do need to be punished in some way. 一方面，罪犯确实需要受到某种方式的惩罚。
- A person who commits a crime must learn that unlawful actions have consequences. 犯罪的人必须懂得违法行为是有后果的。
- Prison sentences punish offenders because they lose their freedom, and are separated from family and friends. 监禁判决惩罚了罪犯，因为他们失去了自由，并与家人和朋友分离。
- In this way, prison acts as a deterrent to make people think carefully before breaking the law. 通过这种方式，监狱起到了威慑作用，让人们在违法前仔细思考。
- Last year in the UK, many people were given a prison sentence for rioting, and hopefully this punishment will deter them from similar behaviour in future. 去年在英国，许多人因参与骚乱被判处监禁，希望这种惩罚能在未来威慑他们不再做出类似行为。
- Analysis (分析):
 - The paragraph contains 5 sentences, with a total of 85 words. This is the kind of length I suggest aiming for. 该段落包含 5 句话，共 85 个单词。这是我建议达到的篇幅长度。
 - The first sentence is short and simple. We often call this type of sentence a 'topic sentence' because it introduces the topic of the paragraph. 第一句话简短而简单。我们通常称这种类型的句子

为“主题句”，因为它引入了段落的主题。

- Sentences 2, 3 and 4 develop the main idea in a logical, step-by-step way: crime has consequences - loss of freedom is the punishment - this stops people from breaking the law. 第 2、3 和 4 句以逻辑严密、循序渐进的方式展开核心观点：犯罪是有后果的 -> 失去自由是惩罚 -> 这阻止了人们违法。
 - Sentence 5 contains a real example. 第 5 句包含了一个真实的例子。
 - Remember that good vocabulary is the key to a high score. I've underlined the best words and phrases in the paragraph. 记住，优质的词汇是取得高分的关键。我已经下划线标注了段落中最好的词汇和短语。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (26) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (26)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'university' topic

雅思写作任务 2：“大学”话题

- Wednesday, May 02, 2012 2012年5月2日，星期三
- The book I mentioned in Monday's lesson (What are Universities for?) reminded me of this question from Cambridge IELTS 7: 我在周一课程中提到的那本书（《大学是干什么的？》）让我想起了剑桥雅思 7 中的这个问题：
- Some people think that universities should provide graduates with the knowledge and skills needed in the workplace. Others think that the true function of a university should be to give access to knowledge for its own sake, regardless of whether the course is useful to an employer. What, in your opinion, should be the function of a university? 有些人认为大学应该为毕业生提供工作场所所需的知识和技能。其他人则认为大学的真正功能应该是为了知识本身而提供获取知识的途径，无论该课程对雇主是否有用。在你看来，大学的功能应该是什么？
- Here are some ideas (一些思路):
 - It would probably be easiest to argue that universities should fulfil both roles (providing vocational skills and knowledge for its own sake). 主张大学应该同时履行这两种角色（提供职业技能和为了知识本身而传授知识）可能是最容易写的。
 - We could use examples to help us generate ideas: try to make a list of some vocational degree courses (that provide training for a specific job), and a list of courses that do not lead to a particular job. 我们可以使用例子来帮助我们产生观点：尝试列出一些职业学位课程（为特定工作提供培训），以及一些不导向特定工作的课程清单。
 - Write one main paragraph explaining the benefits (to the student and to society in general) of the two types of course. 写一个主体段，解释这两类课程的好处（对学生和对整个社会）。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (20) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (20)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'hobbies' essay

雅思写作任务 2: “兴趣爱好”范文

- Wednesday, April 25, 2012 2012年4月25日, 星期三
- I wrote the following essay with some of my students. 我和一些学生一起写了下面这篇文章。
- We tried to keep it clear, concise and well-organised, but it's still good enough for a band 9. 我们试图保持结构清晰、简明扼要且组织良好, 但它仍然足够优秀达到 9 分水平。
- Some people believe that hobbies need to be difficult to be enjoyable. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 有些人认为兴趣爱好需要有难度才会有趣。你在多大程度上同意或不同意?
- Some hobbies are relatively easy, while others present more of a challenge. 有些爱好相对容易, 而另一些爱好则更具挑战性。
- Personally, I believe that both types of hobby can be fun, and I therefore disagree with the statement that hobbies need to be difficult in order to be enjoyable. 就我个人而言, 我认为这两种类型的爱好都可以很有趣, 因此我不同意爱好需要有难度才会有趣的说法。
- On the one hand, many people enjoy easy hobbies. 一方面, 许多人喜欢简单的爱好。
- One example of an activity that is easy for most people is swimming. 对大多数人来说都很简单的一个活动例子是游泳。
- This hobby requires very little equipment, it is simple to learn, and it is inexpensive. 这项爱好需要的设备很少, 学习简单, 而且费用不高。
- I remember learning to swim at my local swimming pool when I was a child, and it never felt like a demanding or challenging experience. 我记得小时候在当地的游泳池学游泳, 从来不觉得那是一件要求高或有挑战性的经历。
- Another hobby that I find easy and fun is photography. 我发现的另一个简单又有意思的爱好是摄影。
- In my opinion, anyone can take interesting pictures without knowing too much about the technicalities of operating a camera. 在我看来, 任何人都可以拍出有趣的照片, 而不需要对操作相机的技术细节了解太多。
- Despite being straightforward, taking photos is a satisfying activity. 尽管很简单, 但拍照是一项令人满意的活动。
- On the other hand, difficult hobbies can sometimes be more exciting. 另一方面, 有难度的爱好有时会更加刺激。
- If an activity is more challenging, we might feel a greater sense of satisfaction when we manage to do it successfully. 如果一项活动更具挑战性, 当我们成功做到时, 可能会感受到更大的满足感。
- For example, film editing is a hobby that requires a high level of knowledge and expertise. 例如, 电影剪辑是一项需要高度知识和专业技能的爱好。
- In my case, it took me around two years before I became competent at this activity, but now I enjoy it much more than I did when I started. 对我来说, 我花了大约两年的时间才胜任这项活动, 但现在我比刚开始时更喜欢它了。
- I believe that many hobbies give us more pleasure when we reach a higher level of performance because the results are better and the feeling of achievement is greater. 我相信, 当我们在许多爱好中达

到更高的水平时，它们会给我们带来更多的快乐，因为结果更好，成就感更大。

- In conclusion, simple hobbies can be fun and relaxing, but difficult hobbies can be equally pleasurable for different reasons. 总之，简单的爱好可以很有趣也很放松，但有难度的爱好出于不同的原因可以同样令人愉悦。
- Note: Notice that we used examples as the basis of both main paragraphs. 注意：注意我们使用了例子作为两个主体段落的基础。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (38) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (38)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'hobbies' essay plan

雅思写作任务 2：“兴趣爱好”文章计划

- Wednesday, April 18, 2012 2012年4月18日，星期三
- Did you try planning some ideas for last week's essay question? 你有尝试为上周的文章问题规划一些想法吗？
- Some people believe that hobbies need to be difficult to be enjoyable. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 有些人认为兴趣爱好需要有难度才会有趣。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？
- When I wrote my list of hobbies, I realised that some were easy and others were difficult. 当我写下我的爱好清单时，我意识到有些很容易，有些很困难。
- As a result, I'd say that "I partly agree" with the statement. 结果，我会说我对这个陈述“部分同意”。
- Here's my 4-paragraph essay plan: 这是我的 4 段式文章计划：
 1. Introduction - write 2 sentences: introduce the topic, and give an overall answer. 开头段 - 写 2 句话：引入主题，并给出一个整体回答。
 2. Main paragraph - about difficult hobbies. My examples: swimming, football, chess. Most sports and games are difficult, but the challenge makes them more enjoyable, especially when you can see that you are improving. 正文段 - 关于有难度的爱好。我的例子：游泳、足球、象棋。大多数体育运动和游戏都很困难，但挑战使它们更有趣，尤其是当你能看到自己在进步时。
 3. Main paragraph - about easy hobbies. My examples: photography, reading, cinema. In my opinion, you do not need to be an expert to enjoy taking photos, reading books, or watching films. I find these activities both easy and enjoyable. 正文段 - 关于简单的爱好。我的例子：摄影、阅读、看电影。在我看来，你不需要成为专家就能享受拍照、读书或看电影的乐趣。我发现这些活动既简单又令人愉快。
 4. Conclusion - repeat / summarise your answer in one sentence. 结尾段 - 用一句话重复 / 总结你的回答。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (19) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (19)

IELTS Writing Task 2: examples give you ideas

雅思写作任务 2：举例能为你提供灵感

- Wednesday, April 11, 2012 2012年4月11日，星期三
- If you can't think of any good ideas for an essay, try thinking about some examples first. 如果你想不到关于文章的任何好主意，不妨尝试先思考一些例子。
- Plan your essay around the examples. 围绕例子来规划你的文章。
- Take this question: 以这个问题为例：
- Some people believe that hobbies need to be difficult to be enjoyable. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 有些人认为兴趣爱好需要有难度才会有趣。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？
- Use examples to give you ideas (使用例子为你提供灵感):
 - Make a list of some hobbies: either your own hobbies, or some typical hobbies that you can easily write about. Label each hobby 'easy' or 'difficult'. 列出一些兴趣爱好：要么是你自己的爱好，要么是一些你可以轻松写作的典型爱好。将每个爱好标为“简单”或“困难”。
 - Look at your list. Is there a balance between easy and difficult hobbies, or is your list one-sided? The answer to this question will give you your overall opinion. 看一看你的清单。简单的爱好和困难的爱好之间是否平衡，或者你的清单是否单倾斜于一边？这个问题的答案将给出你的整体观点。
 - Finally, write down a few reasons why each hobby is easy or difficult. Is there a connection between the difficulty of the hobby and the enjoyment you get from it? 最后，写下每个爱好简单或困难的几个原因。爱好的难度与你从中获得的乐趣之间是否有联系？
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | [Permalink](#) | [Comments \(22\)](#) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | [永久链接](#) | [评论 \(22\)](#)

IELTS Writing Task 2: question types

雅思写作任务 2：提问类型分类

- Wednesday, April 04, 2012 2012年4月4日，星期三
- Here are the four types of question from last week's lesson: 以下是上周课程中的四种提问类型：
 1. Opinion (观点类)
 2. Discussion + opinion (讨论 + 观点类)
 3. Problem + solution (问题 + 解决方案类)
 4. 2-part question (双重提问类)
- Important points to remember (需要记住的重要要点):
 1. An 'opinion' question asks for your view, not the views of other people, and you don't have to give both sides of the argument. Just make your opinion clear in the introduction, then explain it in the rest of the essay. “观点”类问题询问的是你的看法，而不是其他人的看法，你不需要给出论点的双方。只需在开头段明确表达你的观点，然后在文章其余部分解释即可。
 2. A 'discussion' question requires you to write about both sides of the argument, and you should write a similar amount for each view. If the question also asks for your opinion, you don't need an

extra paragraph. Just make it clear in the introduction and conclusion which of the two views you agree with. “讨论”类问题要求你撰写论点的双方，并且你应该为每种观点编写相近的篇幅。如果问题还询问了你的观点，你不需要额外的段落。只需在开头段和结尾段中明确你同意这两种观点中的哪一种即可。

3. Type 3 is easy. Simply write a paragraph explaining the problem(s) and a paragraph explaining the solution(s). Some questions ask about 'causes' or 'effects': these would be part of the 'problem' paragraph. 第3种类型很容易。只需写一个段落解释问题，写一个段落解释解决方案即可。有些问题会问到“原因”或“影响”：这些将是“问题”段落的一部分。
4. For type 4, just answer the two questions. Write one paragraph about each. 对于第4种类型，只需回答这两个问题即可。为每个问题写一个段落。

- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (41) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (41)

IELTS Writing Task 2: four question types

雅思写作任务 2：四种常见题型

- Wednesday, March 28, 2012 2012年3月28日，星期三
- Here are 4 questions that illustrate the different types of task 2 question. 以下是说明任务 2 不同问题类型的 4 个问题。
- Can you name each type? 你能说出每种类型的名称吗？
- Can you explain the big difference between the first and the second type? 你能解释第一种和第二种类型之间的重大区别吗？
 1. Some people think that the only purpose of working hard is to earn money. To what extent do you agree or disagree with this opinion? 有些人认为努力工作的唯一目的是赚钱。你在多大程度上同意或不同意这种观点？
 2. Some people believe that punishment is the only purpose of prisons, while others believe that prisons exist for various reasons. Discuss both views and give your opinion. 有些人认为惩罚是监狱的唯一目的，而另一些人则认为监狱的存在有各种原因。讨论两种观点并给出你的意见。
 3. The number of plants and animals is declining. Explain this problem and suggest some solutions. 动植物的数量正在下降。解释这个问题并提出一些解决方案。
 4. Many people around the world are choosing to move to live in cities. What problems do people experience in big cities? Should governments encourage people to move to smaller towns? 世界各地许多人选择搬到城市生活。人们在大城市里会遇到什么问题？政府应该鼓励人们搬到小城镇吗？
- I'll explain the differences in detail next Wednesday, but feel free to discuss your ideas in the "comments" area below. 我将在下周三详细解释这些区别，但欢迎在下面的“评论”区自由讨论你的想法。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (34) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (34)

IELTS Writing Task 2: topic sentences

雅思写作任务 2：段落主题句

- Wednesday, March 21, 2012 2012年3月21日，星期三
- A good way to start a paragraph is with a short, simple sentence that introduces the main idea of the paragraph. Teachers often call this a 'topic sentence'. 开始一个段落的好方法是用一句简短简单的句子引入段落的核心观点。老师们通常称之为“主题句”。
- I normally write my topic sentences by thinking about how many points I want to mention in the paragraph: 我通常通过思考我想在段落中提及多少个要点来撰写我的主题句：
 1. If I only have one point or idea, I usually state it straight away: 如果我只有一个要点或观点，我通常会直接陈述它：
 - In my opinion, junk food is the main cause of childhood obesity. 在我看来，垃圾食品是儿童肥胖的主要原因。
 - (then explain this opinion and give examples in the rest of the paragraph) (然后在段落其余部分解释该观点并举例)
 2. If I have two or three points or ideas, I don't usually mention them directly in the topic sentence: 如果我有两三个要点或观点，我通常不会在主题句中直接提及它们：
 - There are two main causes (or 'several causes') of childhood obesity. 儿童肥胖有两个主要原因（或“几个原因”）。
 - (then explain using "firstly, secondly..." or something similar) (然后使用“首先，其次.....”或类似的方式进行解释)
- Have a look through the essays that you've written in the past, and compare them with some of mine. Did you begin your main paragraphs with good topic sentences? 翻阅一下你过去写过的文章，并将它们与我的一些文章进行对比。你的主体段落是以优秀的主题句开头的吗？
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (19) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (19)

IELTS Writing Task 2: agree, disagree, or both?

雅思写作任务 2：同意、不同意还是兼而有之？

- For 'agree or disagree' essays, do you think you should give both sides of the argument or just one side? The answer is that you can do either. 对于“同意或不同意”的文章，你认为应该给出论点的双方还是仅给出一方？答案是两者皆可。
- A) Essay structure for one side of the argument (支持单方论点的文章结构)：
 1. Introduction: topic + your opinion (either agree or disagree) 开头段：主题 + 你的观点（同意或不同意）
 2. First idea to support your opinion 支持你观点的第一个想法
 3. Second idea to support your opinion 支持你观点的第二个想法
 4. Conclusion: repeat your opinion 结尾段：重复你的观点

- B) Essay structure for giving both sides (展现双方论点的文章结构):
 1. Introduction: topic + say that you 'partly agree' 开头段: 主题 + 说明你“部分同意”
 2. On the one hand,... 一方面,
 3. On the other hand,... 另一方面,
 4. Conclusion: repeat that you accept elements of both arguments 结尾段: 重复你接受两种论点的合理元素
- Remember: it's very important to get the introduction right. This tells the examiner whether you are going to give one side of the argument or both sides. 记住: 写好开头段非常重要。这会告诉考官你是打算展示单方论点还是双方论点。

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'technology' essay

雅思写作任务 2: “科技”范文

- Several people have asked me about this question from Cambridge IELTS 8. I wrote the essay below with the help of some of my students. A few simple linking features are highlighted. 有几个人问过我剑桥雅思 8 中的这道题目。我在一些学生的帮助下写了下面的文章。高亮突出了一些简单的衔接特征。
- Nowadays the way many people interact with each other has changed because of technology. In what ways has technology affected the types of relationships that people make? Has this been a positive or negative development? 如今, 由于科技的发展, 许多人相互交流的方式发生了改变。科技以何种方式影响了人们建立的人际关系类型? 这是一个积极的发展还是消极的发展?
- It is true that new technologies have had an influence on communication between people. 诚然, 新技术对人与人之间的交流产生了影响。
- Technology has affected relationships in various ways, and in my opinion there are both positive and negative effects. 科技以各种方式影响着人际关系, 在我看来, 积极和消极的影响兼而有之。
- Technology has had an impact on relationships in business, education and social life. 科技对商业、教育和社交生活中的关系产生了影响。
- Firstly, telephones and the Internet allow business people in different countries to interact without ever meeting each other. 首先, 电话和互联网允许不同国家的商务人士在从未谋面的情况下进行互动。
- Secondly, services like Skype create new possibilities for relationships between students and teachers. 其次, 像 Skype 这样的服务为师生关系创造了新的可能性。
- For example, a student can now take video lessons with a teacher in a different city or country. 例如, 学生现在可以与身在不同城市或国家的老师一起上视频课。
- Finally, many people use social networks, like Facebook, to make new friends and find people who share common interests, and they interact through their computers rather than face to face. 最后, 许多人使用像 Facebook 这样的社交网络结交新朋友并寻找有共同兴趣的人, 他们通过电脑而不是面对面地进行互动。
- On the one hand, these developments can be extremely positive. 一方面, 这些发展可以是极其积极的。
- Cooperation between people in different countries was much more difficult when communication was limited to written letters or telegrams. 当通信仅限于书面信件或电报时, 不同国家人们之间的合作要困难得

多。

- Nowadays, interactions by email, phone or video are almost as good as face-to-face meetings, and many of us benefit from these interactions, either in work or social contexts. 如今，通过电子邮件、电话或视频进行的互动几乎与面对面会议一样高效，我们当中的许多人都从这些互动中受益（无论是在工作还是社交语境中）。
- On the other hand, the availability of new communication technologies can also have the result of isolating people and discouraging real interaction. 另一方面，新技术通讯手段的便利也可能导致孤立人们并阻碍现实互动的后果。
- For example, many young people choose to make friends online rather than mixing with their peers in the real world, and these 'virtual' relationships are a poor substitute for real friendships. 例如，许多年轻人选择在网上交友，而不是在现实世界中与同龄人相处，而这些“虚拟”关系是真实友谊的劣质替代品。
- In conclusion, technology has certainly revolutionised communication between people, but not all of the outcomes of this revolution have been positive. 总之，科技确实彻底变革了人与人之间的通信，但这一变革的结果并非都是积极的。
- (257 words, band 9) (257 字，9 分范文)
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (41) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (41)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'art and science' topic

雅思写作任务 2：“艺术与科学”话题

- Wednesday, February 22, 2012 2012年2月22日，星期三
- A student sent me this recent exam question: 一个学生给我发了最近的这道考题：
- These days people pay more attention to artists (writers, painters and so on) and give less importance to science and technology. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 如今人们更多地关注艺术家（作家、画家等），而对科学技术的重视程度有所降低。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？
- This seems to me to be a perfect question for a "balanced opinion" answer (i.e. both art and science are given equal importance). 在我看来，这似乎是一个非常适合给出“中立平衡观点”回答的问题（即艺术和科学都被赋予同等的重要性）。
- However, notice that you need to disagree with the question statement in order to give this balanced response. 然而，请注意你需要不同意题目的陈述，以便给出这个平衡的回答。
- Here's my recommended 4-paragraph essay plan: 这是我推荐的 4 段式文章规划：
 1. Introduction: we could accept that artists are popular nowadays, but disagree that science and technology are treated as less important. 开头段：我们可以承认如今艺术家很受欢迎，但不同意科学技术受到忽视/不被重视的看法。
 2. Main paragraph about the popularity of artists. I'd use examples as the basis for this paragraph. If you don't know any writers or painters, you can talk about actors and musicians. 关于艺术家受欢迎的主体段。我会使用例子作为本段的基础。如果你不知道任何作家或画家，你可以谈论演员和音乐家。

3. Main paragraph about the importance of science and technology. I'd write about the popularity of mobile phones, computers and tablets. Maybe I'd use Steve Jobs or Bill Gates as examples of people who are famous for the technologies they created. 关于科学技术重要性的主体段。我会写手机、电脑和平板电脑的普及。也许我会用史蒂夫·乔布斯或比尔·盖茨作为因创造科技而闻名的人物的例子。
4. Conclusion: paraphrase the argument that you presented in the introduction. 结尾段：改写你在开头段中展示的论点。

- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (33) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (33)

IELTS Writing Task 2: introductions and conclusions

雅思写作任务 2：开头段与结尾段写法

- Wednesday, February 15, 2012 2012年2月15日，星期三
- Many students waste time writing long introductions and conclusions. 许多学生浪费时间写长篇大论的开头段和结尾段。
- These two paragraphs should be short and simple; a long, complex introduction or conclusion will not give you a high score. 这两个段落应该简短而简单；冗长复杂的开头段或结尾段并不能为你带来高分。
- Just make your introductions and conclusions quick and concise, and spend your time writing really good main body paragraphs. 只需让你的开头段和结尾段快速而简明，把时间花在写出真正优秀的正文主体段上。
- Here's my introduction and conclusion for the topic of my last two writing lessons: 这是我前两节写作课主题的开头段和结尾段：
- Introduction (开头段)：
 - There are various benefits and drawbacks of books, radio and television as ways to convey information. 书籍、广播和电视作为传递信息的方式各有优缺点。
 - In my view, television is definitely the most effective of these three media. 在我看来，在这三种媒体中，电视无疑是最有效的。
- Conclusion (结尾段)：
 - In conclusion, although books, radio and television each have their advantages and disadvantages, it seems to me that the impact of television is greater. 总之，虽然书籍、广播和电视各有优缺点，但在我看来，电视的影响力更大。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (42) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (42)

IELTS Writing Task 2: books, radio, TV

雅思写作任务 2：“书籍、广播与电视”

- Wednesday, February 08, 2012 2012年2月8日，星期三

- Here are my 'main body' paragraphs for last week's question. 以下是我针对上周问题的“正文主体”段落。
- Notice that it's possible to put advantages and disadvantages together in the same paragraph. 注意，将优点和缺点放在同一个段落中是可行的。
- Also, you need to be careful not to write too much! 此外，你需要注意不要写得太多！
- Advantages / disadvantages of books (书籍的优缺点):
- The main advantage of books is that they are usually considered to be reliable sources of information. 书籍的主要优点是它们通常被认为是可靠的信息来源。
- People tend to refer to books when they want to research a subject in depth, and for this reason they continue to play an important role in education. 当人们想要深入研究某个主题时，往往会参考书籍，因此，书籍在教育中继续发挥着重要作用。
- On the other hand, books quickly go out of date, and therefore they are not the best medium for communicating news stories. 另一方面，书籍很快就会过时，因此它们不是传播新闻报道的最佳媒介。
- Advantages / disadvantages of radio (广播的优缺点):
- Radio is a much more effective medium than books for the communication of up-to-date information. 在传播最新信息方面，广播是比书籍有效得多的媒介。
- We can listen to news broadcasts about events as they happen, and a key benefit of radio is that we can listen to it while doing other activities, such as driving or working. 我们可以在事件发生时收听新闻广播，而广播的一个核心好处是我们可以边做其他活动（如开车载货或工作）边收听。
- The main drawback of radio, when compared to books or television, is that there is no visual element; we cannot see what the broadcaster is describing. 与书籍或电视相比，广播的主要缺点是没有视觉元素；我们看不到广播员所描述的内容。
- Advantages / disadvantages of TV, and my opinion (电视的优缺点及我的观点):
- In my opinion, television is the most effective of these three media because it brings us closer to reality than a book or radio programme ever can. 在我看来，电视是这三种媒介中最有效的，因为它比书籍或广播节目更能让我们贴近现实。
- For example, we can watch events as they take place on the other side of the world, or we can see the body language of a politician who is being interviewed. 例如，我们可以观看世界另一端发生的事件，或者看到被采访政治家的肢体语言。
- The disadvantages of television are that programmes tend to be short and interrupted by advertisements, meaning that information is presented in limited depth. 电视的缺点是节目往往较短且会被广告打断，这意味着呈现的信息深度有限。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (33) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (33)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'media' topic

雅思写作任务 2：“媒体”话题

- Wednesday, February 01, 2012 2012年2月1日，星期三

- Several people have asked me about the following question from Cambridge IELTS book 4. 有几个人向我询问了剑桥雅思第 4 册中的以下问题。
- Compare the advantages and disadvantages of three of the following as media for communicating information. State which you consider to be the most effective. 比较以下作为信息传播媒体中的三种方式的优缺点。说明你认为哪一种最有效。
 - comics (漫画)
 - books (书籍)
 - radio (广播)
 - television (电视)
 - film (电影)
 - theatre (戏剧)
- Usually I recommend writing 4 paragraphs, but for this question I think I would write 5 paragraphs: 通常我建议写 4 个段落，但对于这个问题，我认为我会写 5 个段落：
 1. Introduction: state which 3 media you are going to write about (e.g. books, radio, TV), and say which you think is most effective (e.g. television). 开头段：说明你打算写哪 3 种媒体（例如：书籍、广播、电视），并说明你认为哪种最有效（例如：电视）。
 2. Advantages and disadvantages of books. 第二段：书籍的优缺点。
 3. Advantages and disadvantages of radio. 第三段：广播的优缺点。
 4. Advantages and disadvantages of TV (mention again that you consider this the most effective). 第四段：电视的优缺点（再次提及你认为这是最有效的）。
 5. Conclusion: summarise and repeat your opinion. 结尾段：总结并重复你的观点。
- Maybe you can share your ideas about the advantages and disadvantages of these 3 media, and I'll use them to write an essay for next week's lesson. 也许你可以分享你对这 3 种媒体优缺点的看法，我将用它们为下周的课程写一篇文章。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (35) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (35)

IELTS Writing Task 2: full essay

雅思写作任务 2：完整范文总结

- Wednesday, January 25, 2012 2012年1月25日，星期三
- Today I'm attaching the full essay (click here) that we've been working on for the last 2 weeks. 今天我附上过去 2 周我们一直在写的完整文章（[点击这里](#)）。
- Here are some points to notice: 以下是一些需要注意要点：
 - There is a clear 4-paragraph structure, and the essay is easy to read because the ideas are developed in a logical way. 有着清晰的 4 段式结构，文章易于阅读，因为观点是以逻辑严密的方式展开的。

- The introduction is short, but it covers everything that the question asks you about. 开头段很短，但它涵盖了问题询问你的所有内容。
- The main paragraphs make up around 70% of the essay. These paragraphs are the key to a high score. 主体段落大约占文章全篇的 70%。这些段落是获得高分的关键。
- The conclusion is very short, and simply summarises what I had already written. Never put any new ideas in the conclusion. 结尾段非常短，只是简单总结了我已经写过的内容。切勿在结尾段中放入任何新观点。
- I focus on expressing my ideas well, using a range of relevant words and phrases. I'm not thinking about 'complex grammar' or linking phrases. 我专注于良好地表达自己的想法，使用一系列相关的单词和短语。我没有去刻意琢磨“复杂的语法”或连接短语。
- Note: I went a bit "over the top" with this essay. It's 310 words long, and more than good enough for band 9. You might not be able to write like this, but hopefully you can learn something from it. 注意：我在写这篇文章时有点“超常施展”了。它长达 310 个字，足以达到 9 分水平。你可能无法写成这样，但希望你能从中学到一些东西。
- (go over the top: to do something that is more than what is considered normal or suitable) (go over the top: 做超出常规或适当范围的事情/夸张/超常做某事)
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (20) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (20)

IELTS Writing Task 2: main body paragraphs

雅思写作任务 2：正文主体段示范

- Wednesday, January 18, 2012 2012年1月18日，星期三
- Here are my 2 main body paragraphs for last week's question. 以下是我针对上周问题的 2 个正文主体段。
- I tried to use an "Idea, Explain, Example" structure for the first paragraph, and a "Firstly, Secondly, Finally" structure for the second. 我尝试为第一段使用“观点 -> 解释 -> 举例”的结构，为第二段使用“首先，其次，最后”的结构。
- Main body paragraphs (正文主体段):
- On the one hand, having a defined career path can certainly lead to a satisfying working life. 一方面，拥有明确的职业道路固然可以带来满意的职业生活。
- Many people decide as young children what they want to do as adults, and it gives them a great sense of satisfaction to work towards their goals and gradually achieve them. 许多人在幼年时就决定了成年后想做什么，朝自己的目标努力并逐步实现目标会给他们带来极大的满足感。
- For example, many children dream of becoming doctors, but to realise this ambition they need to gain the relevant qualifications and undertake years of training. 例如，许多孩子梦想成为医生，但要实现这一抱负，他们需要获得相关资格并进行多年的培训。
- In my experience, very few people who have qualified as doctors choose to change career because they find their work so rewarding, and because they have invested so much time and effort to reach their goal. 根据我的经验，极少数取得医生资格的人会选择改变职业，因为他们发现自己的工作非常有意義，而且他

们投入了大量的时间和精力来实现目标。

- On the other hand, people find happiness in their working lives in different ways. 另一方面，人们在工作生活中以不同的方式找到幸福。
- Firstly, not everyone dreams of doing a particular job, and it can be equally rewarding to try a variety of professions; starting out on a completely new career path can be a reinvigorating experience. 首先，并不是每个人都梦想从事某项特定的工作，尝试各种职业可以同样有收获；踏上一条全新的职业道路可以是一种重新焕发生机的体验。
- Secondly, some people see their jobs as simply a means of earning money, and they are happy if their salary is high enough to allow them to enjoy life outside work. 其次，有些人把工作仅仅看作是赚钱的手段，如果薪水足够高，能让他们享受工作之外的生活，他们就会感到满足。
- Finally, job satisfaction is often the result of working conditions, rather than the career itself. 最后，工作满意度往往是工作条件的结果，而不是职业本身。
- For example, a positive working atmosphere, enthusiastic colleagues, and an inspirational boss can make working life much more satisfying, regardless of the profession. 例如，积极的工作氛围、热情的同事和富有感染力的老板可以使工作生活更加令人满意，无论从事什么职业。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (33) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (33)

IELTS Writing Task 2: rules for introductions

雅思写作任务 2：开头段原则

- Wednesday, January 11, 2012 2012年1月11日，星期三
- Many people decide on a career path early in their lives and keep to it. This, they argue, leads to a more satisfying working life. To what extent do you agree with this view? What other things can people do in order to have a satisfying working life? 许多人在很年轻时就决定了职业道路并坚持下去。他们认为，这能带来更满意的职业生活。你在多大程度上同意这种观点？为了拥有满意的职业生活，人们还可以做哪些其他事情？
- In today's lesson I just want to look at how to write an introduction for this type of question. 在今天的课程中，我只想研究如何为这种类型的题目写开头段。
- My simple rules for task 2 introductions are: 我对任务 2 开头段的简单原则是：
 1. Write 2 sentences: introduce the topic, then give a general answer. 写 2 句话：引入主题，然后给出概括性回答。
 2. Mention everything that the question mentions. 提及题目中提及的所有内容。
 3. Don't save any surprises for the conclusion; give your opinion in the introduction if the question asks for it. 不要把惊喜留到结尾段；如果题目询问你的观点，请在开头段中给出。
- Here's an example introduction: 这是一个开头段范例：
- It is true that some people know from an early age what career they want to pursue, and they are happy to spend the rest of their lives in the same profession. 诚然，有些人从小就知道自己想从事什么职业，并且

乐于在余生中从事同一职业。

- While I accept that this may suit many people, I believe that others enjoy changing careers or seeking job satisfaction in different ways. 虽然我承认这可能适合许多人，但我认为其他人喜欢改变职业或以不同的方式寻求工作满意度。
- I'll look at the main paragraphs next week. 我下周将研究正文主体段。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | [Permalink](#) | [Comments \(50\)](#) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | [永久链接](#) | [评论 \(50\)](#)

IELTS Writing Task 2: using the word "I"

雅思写作任务 2：使用第一人称“I”

- Wednesday, January 04, 2012 2012年1月4日，星期三
- Here is a question that a lot of students ask: Is it acceptable to use "I" or "my" in IELTS writing? 这是许多学生问的问题：在雅思写作中使用“I”或“my”是可以接受的吗？
- As an ex-examiner, my advice is that you should use phrases like "I believe" or "in my opinion" when the question asks for your opinion e.g. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 作为前考官，我的建议是，当题目询问你的观点时（例如：你在多大程度上同意或不同意？），你应该使用像“I believe”或“in my opinion”这样的短语。
- Some teachers tell students not to use "I" in academic essays, but this advice is really for university academic writing, not IELTS. 有些老师告诉学生不要在学术论文中使用“I”，但这个建议实际上适用于大学学术论文写作，而不是雅思。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | [Permalink](#) | [Comments \(32\)](#) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | [永久链接](#) | [评论 \(32\)](#)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'nuclear power' topic

雅思写作任务 2：“核能”话题

- Wednesday, December 28, 2011 2011年12月28日，星期三
- Following on from yesterday's listening lesson, here is a paragraph explaining some of the benefits of nuclear power: 接续昨天的听力课，这是一个解释核能一些好处的段落：
- There are several benefits to building more nuclear power stations. 建设更多的核电站有几个好处。
- Firstly, nuclear power is a relatively sustainable energy source, meaning that it can be used to produce electricity without wasting limited natural resources like coal, oil or gas. 首先，核能是一种相对可持续的能源，这意味着它可以用于发电，而不会浪费煤炭、石油或天然气等有限的自然资源。
- Secondly, nuclear power stations are cleaner than fossil fuel power stations, and could help to reduce carbon emissions that cause global warming. 其次，核电站比化石燃料电站更清洁，有助于减少导致全球变暖的碳排放。
- With improvements in nuclear technology, the risks of accidents are being reduced. 随着核技术的改进，发生事故的风险正在降低。

- As a result, many countries are now considering nuclear power as a solution to high oil and gas prices, increasing demand for electricity, and worries about pollution and climate change. 因此，许多国家现在正考虑将核能作为应对高油价和高气价、日益增长的用电需求以及对污染和气候变化的担忧的解决方案。
- Read, analyse and use the paragraph (阅读、分析并利用该段落):
 - How many sentences are there, and what does each sentence do? 有多少句话，每句话起了什么作用？
 - Note the main ideas and collocations (e.g. sustainable energy source). 记录核心观点和搭配（例如：可持续能源）。
 - Try to rewrite the paragraph using only your notes. 尝试仅使用你的笔记来重写该段落。
- PS. If you have my ebook, you will find some ideas for the 'negatives of nuclear power' in the environment chapter on page 19. 注：如果你有我的电子书，你会在第 19 页的环境一章中找到关于“核能弊端”的一些想法。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (23) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (23)

IELTS Writing Task 2: short introductions

雅思写作任务 2：简短的开头段

- Wednesday, December 21, 2011 2011年12月21日，星期三
- It's a good idea to practise writing short, fast introductions. 练习写简短迅速的开头段是一个好主意。
- If you can write the introduction quickly, you will have more time to focus on the main paragraphs - these are the key to a high score. 如果你能快速写完开头段，你将有更多的时间专注于主体段落——这些才是取得高分的关键。
- Here's a question that someone asked me about: 这是一个有人问过我的问题：
- In many cities, security measures, such as the use of video cameras in public places, are being increased in order to reduce crime, but some people believe that these measures restrict our individual freedom. Do the benefits of increased security outweigh the drawbacks? 在许多城市，为了减少犯罪，正在加强安全措施（如在公共场所使用摄像头），但有些人认为这些措施限制了我们的个人自由。增加安全措施的好处大于缺点吗？
- Here's my short, fast introduction: 这是我简短迅速的开头段：
- It is true that the security in many cities has been tightened in recent years. 诚然，近年来许多城市的安保措施都有所加强。
- Although I agree that some security measures can feel restrictive, I believe that there are more benefits than drawbacks. 虽然我承认某些安全措施可能会让人感到受限制，但我认为好处多于缺点。
- Note (注意):
 - In reality, it might not be true that security has been increased in most cities, but I think we have to accept this in order to answer the question. 在现实中，大多数城市的安保措施是否加强可能并非绝对事实，但我认为为了回答问题我们必须接受这一点。

- The question gives us an example of increased security (video cameras), so we can definitely use that example in a paragraph about the drawbacks. 题目给出了一个增加安保措施的例子（摄像摄像头），所以我们绝对可以在关于缺点的段落中使用这个例子。
- Notice that my introduction paraphrases the question. I've used some of the words from the question, but there are some nice changes too (e.g. tightened, feel restrictive). 注意我的开头段改写了题目。我使用了题目中的一些词，但也做了一些很好的改变（例如：tightened, feel restrictive）。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (51) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (51)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'global warming' topic

雅思写作任务 2: “全球变暖”话题

- Wednesday, December 14, 2011 2011年12月14日，星期三
- If the question asks you to explain a problem related to the environment, you could write about global warming. 如果题目要求你解释一个与环境相关的问题，你可以写全球变暖。
- Here is a paragraph explaining the problem (causes) of global warming: 这是一个解释全球变暖问题（原因）的段落：
- Perhaps the most serious problem facing the environment is global warming. 环境面临的最严重问题也许是全球变暖。
- Gases such as carbon dioxide trap heat from the sun within the earth's atmosphere, and this causes global temperatures to rise. 二氧化碳等气体将来自太阳的热量困在地球大气层内，这导致全球气温上升。
- This process is known as the greenhouse effect, and human activity is a major factor in the rise of the greenhouse gases which cause it. 这个过程被称为温室效应，而人类活动是导致温室效应的气体增加的主要因素。
- For example, factories and vehicles produce emissions and exhaust fumes. 例如，工厂和车辆产生排放物和废气。
- As many developing countries are becoming industrialised, emissions from factories are expected to increase. 随着许多发展中国家正在工业化，工厂的排放量预计将增加。
- Furthermore, the number of cars on our streets is growing all the time, and cheap air travel is making flying accessible to more and more people. 此外，我们街道上的汽车数量一直在增加，便宜的航空旅行使越来越多的人能够乘坐飞机。
- Consequently, the amount of greenhouse gases released into the atmosphere shows no signs of decreasing. 因此，释放到大气中的温室气体数量没有减少的迹象。
- You can learn a lot from this paragraph if you analyse it: 如果你分析这个段落，你可以学到很多东西：
 1. How many sentences are there? What does each sentence do? (e.g. The first sentence introduces the topic) 有多少句话？每句话起了什么作用？（例如：第一句引入了主题）
 2. Can you find some "band 7 vocabulary"? 你能找到一些“7分词汇”吗？
 3. Look at how the ideas are linked. Can you see that the word "this" is an important linking word? 看

一看观点是如何连接的。你能看到“this”这个词是一个重要的连接词吗？

- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (23) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (23)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'help' essay

雅思写作任务 2：“援助与慈善”范文

- Wednesday, December 07, 2011 2011年12月7日，星期三
- Last week I wrote a plan for the question below. Now you can read my full essay. 上周我为下面的问题写了一个计划。现在你可以阅读我的完整文章。
- We cannot help everyone in the world that needs help, so we should only be concerned with our own communities and countries. To what extent do you agree or disagree with this statement? 我们无法帮助世界上每一个需要帮助的人，因此我们应该只关注我们自己的社区和国家。你在多大程度上同意或不同意这种说法？
- Some people believe that we should not help people in other countries as long as there are problems in our own society. 有些人认为，只要我们自己的社会存在问题，我们就不应该帮助其他国家的人。
- I disagree with this view because I believe that we should try to help as many people as possible. 我不同意这种观点，因为我认为我们应该尝试帮助尽可能多的人。
- On the one hand, I accept that it is important to help our neighbours and fellow citizens. 一方面，我承认帮助我们的邻居和同胞是重要的。
- In most communities there are people who are impoverished or disadvantaged in some way. 在大多数社区中，都有贫困或在某些方面处于弱势的人。
- It is possible to find homeless people, for example, in even the wealthiest of cities, and for those who are concerned about this problem, there are usually opportunities to volunteer time or give money to support these people. 例如，即使在最富裕的城市里，也可能找到无家可归的人，对于那些关注这个问题的人来说，通常有机会志愿奉献时间或捐钱来支持这些人。
- In the UK, people can help in a variety of ways, from donating clothing to serving free food in a soup kitchen. 在英国，人们可以通过各种方式提供帮助，从捐赠衣物到在救济厨房分发免费食物。
- As the problems are on our doorstep, and there are obvious ways to help, I can understand why some people feel that we should prioritise local charity. 由于问题就在我们身边，而且有显而易见的帮助途径，我能理解为什么有些人觉得我们应该优先考虑本地慈善机构。
- At the same time, I believe that we have an obligation to help those who live beyond our national borders. 同时，我认为我们有义务帮助那些生活在我们国界之外的人。
- In some countries the problems that people face are much more serious than those in our own communities, and it is often even easier to help. 在一些国家，人们面临的问题比我们自己社区的问题要严重得多，而且往往更容易提供帮助。
- For example, when children are dying from curable diseases in African countries, governments and individuals in richer countries can save lives simply by paying for vaccines that already exist. 例如，当非洲国家的儿童死于可治愈的疾病时，较富裕国家的政府和个人只需支付现有的疫苗费用就可以拯救生命。

- A small donation to an international charity might have a much greater impact than helping in our local area. 给国际慈善机构的一小笔捐款可能比在我们当地提供帮助产生大得多的影响。
- In conclusion, it is true that we cannot help everyone, but in my opinion national boundaries should not stop us from helping those who are in need. 总之，我们确实无法帮助所有人，但在我看来，国界不应该阻止我们去帮助那些需要帮助的人。
- (280 words, band 9) (280 字，9 分范文)
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (39) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (39)

IELTS Writing Task 2: who should we help?

雅思写作任务 2：我们应该帮助谁？

- Wednesday, November 30, 2011 2011年11月30日，星期三
- We cannot help everyone in the world that needs help, so we should only be concerned with our own communities and countries. To what extent do you agree or disagree with this statement? 我们无法帮助世界上每一个需要帮助的人，因此我们应该只关注我们自己的社区和国家。你在多大程度上同意或不同意这种说法？
- Let's plan an essay for this question (让我们为这个问题规划一篇文章):
 1. Introduction - I don't think there is a "middle" opinion for this question. You either agree that we should only be worried about our own communities and countries, or you think that we should also help those outside our own countries. The best response might be to disagree - then you can say that we should try to help everyone. 开头段 - 我认为这个问题没有“折中”观点。你要么同意我们应该只关心自己的社区和国家，要么认为我们也应该帮助本国以外的人。最好的回应可能是不同意——这样你就可以说我们应该尝试帮助每个人。
 2. Paragraph 2 - I agree that it is important to help our neighbours and fellow citizens. (Explain this idea) 第 2 段 - 我同意帮助我们的邻居和同胞是重要的。（解释这个想法）
 3. Paragraph 3 - At the same time, I believe that we have an obligation to help those who live beyond our national borders. (Explain) 第 3 段 - 同时，我认为我们有义务帮助那些生活在我们国界之外的人。（解释）
 4. Conclusion - Repeat the idea that we can help people both at home and abroad. 结尾段 - 重申我们既可以帮助国内的人也可以帮助国外的人的观点。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (33) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (33)

IELTS Writing Task 2: conclusions

雅思写作任务 2：结尾段常用表达

- Wednesday, November 23, 2011 2011年11月23日，星期三
- Several people have asked me about conclusions for IELTS Writing Task 2. 有几个人问过我关于雅思写作任

务 2 的结尾段问题。

- The main body paragraphs are much more important, so don't worry too much about the conclusion; make it short, simple and fast. 正文主体段要重要得多，所以不要过于担心结尾段；让它简短、简单且迅速完成。
- Here are some example conclusion phrases for different types of question: 以下是针对不同类型问题的结尾段短语示例：

1. Opinion (观点类):

- For the reasons mentioned above, I believe that... (+ repeat your opinion). 基于上述原因，我认为.....（+ 重复你的观点）。

2. Discussion (+ Opinion) (讨论 + 观点类):

- In conclusion, there are convincing arguments both for and against... (topic), but I believe that... (if the question asks for your opinion). 总之，支持和反对.....（主题）的论点都很有说服力，但我认为.....（如果问题询问你的观点）。

3. Advantages and Disadvantages (利弊类):

- In conclusion, I would argue that the benefits of... (topic) outweigh the drawbacks. 总之，我认为.....（主题）的好处大于弊端。

4. Problem and Solution (问题与解决方案类):

- In conclusion, it is clear that there are various reasons for... (topic), and steps need to be taken to tackle this problem. 总之，很明显.....（主题）有各种各样的原因，需要采取措施来解决问题。

- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | [Permalink](#) | [Comments \(23\)](#) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | [永久链接](#) | [评论 \(23\)](#)

IELTS Writing Task 2: discussion without opinion

雅思写作任务 2：无观点的讨论类

- Wednesday, November 16, 2011 2011年11月16日，星期三
- Most discussion essays also ask for your opinion. Sometimes, however, the question doesn't ask for your opinion. 大多数讨论类文章也会询问你的观点。然而，有时问题并没有询问你的观点。
- It might just ask you to discuss two different views, or compare the advantages and disadvantages. 它可能只是要求你讨论两种不同的观点，或者比较优点和缺点。
- Remember: if the question doesn't ask for your opinion, don't give it. 记住：如果题目没有询问你的观点，就不要给。
- Compare the 2 essays attached below. 对比下面附带的 2 篇文章。
- They are almost the same, but in the first essay I give my opinion clearly in several places, while in the second essay I've removed my opinions completely. 它们几乎是一样的，但是在第一篇文章中，我在几个地方明确给出了我的观点，而在第二篇文章中，我完全删除了我的观点。

- Click here to download essays 点击这里下载文章
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (35) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (35)

IELTS Writing Task 2: plan your main paragraphs

雅思写作任务 2：规划你的主体段落

- Wednesday, November 09, 2011 2011年11月9日，星期三
- Before you start writing your task 2 essay, you need a plan: 在你开始写任务 2 文章之前，你需要一个计划：
 1. First, think about how you could write 2 main body paragraphs. What would be the main idea/topic of each one? 首先，思考你可以如何写 2 个正文主体段。每个段落的核心观点/主题是什么？
 2. Then make some notes for the first main paragraph. Your notes could follow this formula: Idea, Explain, Example. 然后为第一个主体段做一些笔记。你的笔记可以遵循这个公式：观点 -> 解释 -> 举例。
 3. Do the same thing for the second main paragraph. 对第二个主体段做同样的事情。
- Here's an example question with a few ideas below: 这是一个示例问题，下面有一些想法：
- People nowadays work hard to buy more things. This has made our lives generally more comfortable, but many traditional values and customs have been lost and this is a pity. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 如今人们努力工作是为了购买更多的东西。这使得我们的生活总体上更加舒适，但许多传统价值和习俗已经丧失，这非常可惜。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？
 1. I can see two clear ideas in this question: 1) buying things has made our lives more comfortable. 2) traditional values and customs have been lost. I agree with both of these points, so I'll write one paragraph explaining why I agree with the first point, and another paragraph explaining the second point. 在这个问题中我可以看到两个清晰的观点：1) 购买商品使我们的生活更加舒适。2) 传统价值和习俗已经丧失。我同意这两点，所以我会写一个段落解释我为什么同意第一点，写另一个段落解释第二点。
 2. Idea: buying things has made life more comfortable. Explain/Examples: we buy appliances like microwave ovens and dishwashers; we use computers to shop online; more people own a car. 观点：买东西使生活更舒适。解释/例子：我们购买微波炉和洗碗机等家电；我们使用电脑网上购物；更多的人拥有汽车。
 3. Idea: traditional values and customs have been lost. Explain/Examples: people buy microwave meals rather than cooking traditional dishes; traditional local shops disappear and are replaced with online shopping; people are more independent, but lack a sense of community. 观点：传统价值和习俗已经丧失。解释/例子：人们买微波加热食品而不是做传统菜肴；传统的当地商店消失了，被网上购物所取代；人们更加独立，但缺乏社区归属感。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (41) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (41)

IELTS Writing Task 2: 'equality' topic

雅思写作任务 2: “平等”话题

- Wednesday, November 02, 2011 2011年11月2日, 星期三
- Here's my full (band 9) essay for last week's question. 这是我对上周问题的完整 (9 分) 范文。
- In recent years, there has been growing interest in the relationship between equality and personal achievement. Some people believe that individuals can achieve more in egalitarian societies. Others believe that high levels of personal achievement are possible only if individuals are free to succeed or fail according to their individual merits. What is your view of the relationship between equality and personal success? 近年来, 人们对平等与个人成就之间的关系越来越感兴趣。有些人认为, 个人在平等主义社会中可以取得更大的成就。另一些人则认为, 只有当个人能够根据其个人优缺点自由地成功或失败时, 才可能取得高水平的个人成就。你对平等与个人成功之间的关系有何看法?
- In my opinion, an egalitarian society is one in which everyone has the same rights and the same opportunities. 在我看来, 一个平等主义社会是一个每个人都拥有相同权利和相同机会的社会。
- I completely agree that people can achieve more in this kind of society. 我完全同意人们在这种社会中可以取得更大的成就。
- Education is an important factor with regard to personal success in life. 教育是关乎人生个人成功的关键因素。
- I believe that all children should have access to free schooling, and higher education should be either free or affordable for all those who chose to pursue a university degree. 我认为所有儿童都应该接受免费教育, 并且对于所有选择攻读大学学位的人来说, 高等教育应该是免费的或负担得起的。
- In a society without free schooling or affordable higher education, only children and young adults from wealthier families would have access to the best learning opportunities, and they would therefore be better prepared for the job market. 在一个没有免费学校教育或负担得起的高等教育的社会, 只有来自较富裕家庭的儿童和年轻人才能获得最好的学习机会, 因此他们将为就业市场做好更好的准备。
- This kind of inequality would ensure the success of some but harm the prospects of others. 这种不平等会确保一部分人的成功, 但会损害另一部分人的前景。
- I would argue that equal rights and opportunities are not in conflict with people's freedom to succeed or fail. 我认为平等的权利和机会与人们成功或失败的自由并不冲突。
- In other words, equality does not mean that people lose their motivation to succeed, or that they are not allowed to fail. 换句话说, 平等并不意味着人们失去成功的动力, 或者他们不被允许失败。
- On the contrary, I believe that most people would feel more motivated to work hard and reach their potential if they thought that they lived in a fair society. 相反, 我相信如果人们认为自己生活在一个公平的社会中, 大多数人会更有动力努力工作并发挥潜力。
- Those who did not make the same effort would know that they had wasted their opportunity. 那些没有付出同样努力的人 would know that they had wasted their opportunity. 那些没有付出同样努力的人 would know that they had wasted their opportunity.
- Inequality, on the other hand, would be more likely to demotivate people because they would know that the odds of success were stacked in favour of those from privileged backgrounds. 另一方面, 不平等更有可能挫伤人们的积极性, 因为他们知道成功的几率倾斜于那些拥有特权背景的人。
- In conclusion, it seems to me that there is a positive relationship between equality and personal success.

总之，在我看来，平等与个人成功之间存在正相关关系。

- (260 words) (260 字)
- Note: I'm not sure that this was a 'real' IELTS question (maybe the student who sent it to me remembered it wrongly) because it is a bit confusing: it seems strange to me to imply that "egalitarian/equality" is the opposite of "free to succeed or fail". Anyway, I hope you still find the essay useful. 注意：我不确定这是否是一个“真实”的雅思考题（也许发给我的学生记错了），因为它有点令人困惑：在我看来，暗示“平等主义/平等”是“自由成功或失败”的对立面似乎很奇怪。无论如何，希望你仍然发现这篇文章有用。

IELTS Writing Task 2: difficult questions

雅思写作任务 2：难题应对

- A student sent me this question, and I agree that it's difficult: 一个学生给我发了这个问题，我承认它很难：
- In recent years, there has been growing interest in the relationship between equality and personal achievement. Some people believe that individuals can achieve more in egalitarian societies. Others believe that high levels of personal achievement are possible only if individuals are free to succeed or fail according to their individual merits. What is your view of the relationship between equality and personal success? 近年来，人们对平等与个人成就之间的关系越来越感兴趣。有些人认为，个人在平等主义社会中可以取得更大的成就。另一些人则认为，只有当个人能够根据其个人优缺点自由地成功或失败时，才可能取得高水平的个人成就。你对平等与个人成功之间的关系有何看法？
- Faced with this question, here are 3 tips: 面对这个问题，这里有 3 个技巧：
 1. Have a strong opinion (e.g. I completely agree that people can achieve more in egalitarian societies.) You can ignore the other view. 持强烈的观点（例如：我完全同意人们在平等主义社会中可以取得更大的成就）。你可以忽略另一种观点。
 2. Focus on the last line of the question (What is your view of...?). This line sums up the whole question very clearly. Just answer this question. 专注于问题的最后一行（你对.....有何看法？）。这一行非常清晰地总结了整个问题。只需回答这个问题。
 3. Use examples as the basis of your argument e.g. free university education ensures equality of opportunity, and therefore allows individuals to achieve more. 使用例子作为你论点的基础，例如：免费大学教育确保了机会平等，从而允许个人取得更大的成就。
- If you try writing an essay for this question, you can compare your essay with my answer next Wednesday. 如果你尝试为这个问题写一篇文章，你可以在下周三将你的文章与我的答案进行对比。
- I'm afraid I can't check essays or give scores. 恐怕我无法批改文章或打分。
- Note: 'egalitarian' refers to the principle that people are equal, and deserve equal rights and opportunities. 注：'egalitarian'（平等主义的）指的是人人平等、享有平等权利和机会的原则。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (23) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (23)

IELTS Writing Task 2: higher education

雅思写作任务 2: “高等教育”话题

- Wednesday, October 19, 2011 2011年10月19日, 星期三
- Some people believe that studying at university or college is the best route to a successful career, while others believe that it is better to get a job straight after school. Discuss both views and give your opinion. 有些人认为在大学或大专学习是走向成功职业生涯的最佳途径, 而另一些人则认为高中毕业后直接找工作更好。讨论两种观点并给出你的意见。
- Here's my full introduction and conclusion, as well as some ideas for the main body paragraphs: 这是我的完整开头段和结尾段, 以及正文主体段的一些想法:
- Introduction (开头段):
- When they finish school, teenagers face the dilemma of whether to get a job or continue their education. 当他们完成学业时, 青少年面临着是找工作还是继续接受教育的抉择。
- While there are some benefits to getting a job straight after school, I would argue that it is better to go to college or university. 虽然高中毕业后直接找工作有一些好处, 但我认为去大专或大学更好。
- Paragraph 1: benefits of getting a job (第 1 段: 直接找工作的好处)
 - The option to start work straight after school is attractive for several reasons. 毕业后直接开始工作的选择出于几个原因而具有吸引力。
 - (IDEAS: start earning money, become independent, gain experience, learn skills, get promotions, settle down earlier, afford a house, have a family) (观点: 开始赚钱、变得独立、积累经验、学习技能、获得晋升、更早安定下来、买得起房、组建家庭)
- Paragraph 2: benefits of higher education (my opinion) (第 2 段: 接受高等教育的好处 (我的观点))
 - On the other hand, I believe that it is more beneficial for students to continue their studies. 另一方面, 我认为对于学生来说继续学业更有利。
 - (IDEAS: some jobs require academic qualifications, better job opportunities, higher salaries, the job market is very competitive, gain knowledge, become a useful member of society) (观点: 某些工作需要学术学历、更好的工作机会、更高的薪水、就业市场竞争激烈、获取知识、成为对社会有用的一员)
- Conclusion (结尾段):
- For the reasons mentioned above, it seems to me that students are more likely to be successful in their lives if they continue their studies beyond school level. 基于上述原因, 在我看来, 如果学生在高中水平之外继续深造, 他们的人生更有可能取得成功。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (47) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (47)

IELTS Writing Task 2: example paragraph

雅思写作任务 2: 主体段示例

- Wednesday, October 12, 2011 2011年10月12日, 星期三

- Here's a 5-sentence paragraph using the second plan from last week's lesson: 这是一个使用上周课程中第二个计划编写的 5 句话段落：
- Many people believe that sports professionals earn too much money. 许多人认为体育专业人员赚的钱太多了。
- They argue that sport is a form of entertainment rather than a vital public service. 他们认为体育是一种娱乐形式，而不是一项至关重要的公共服务。
- We could easily live without sportspeople, yet other professionals who contribute much more to society are undervalued and underpaid. 没有体育界人士我们也可以轻松生活，然而其他对社会贡献更大得多的专业人员却被低估且薪酬过低。
- For example, football players can earn enormous salaries by simply kicking a ball, while doctors, nurses and teachers earn a fraction of the money despite being essential for our health and prosperity. 例如，足球运动员只需踢球就能赚取巨额薪水，而医生、护士和教师尽管对我们的健康和繁荣至关重要，但赚取的钱却只是其中的一小部分。
- From this perspective, sports stars do not deserve the salaries they currently earn. 从这个角度来看，体育明星不配获得他们目前赚取的薪水。
- As you can see, the paragraph explains the view that sportspeople earn too much money. This came from a discuss both views question. 如你所见，该段落解释了体育界人士赚太多钱的观点。这来自一个“讨论双方观点”的问题。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (17) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (17)

IELTS Writing: 5 sentence paragraphs

雅思写作：5 句话构段法

- Saturday, October 08, 2011 2011年10月8日，星期六
- When writing main body paragraphs for IELTS writing task 2, try to aim for five sentences. For example: 在为雅思写作任务 2 撰写正文主体段时，尽量以 5 句话为目标。例如：
 1. Topic sentence (e.g. There are several reasons why I believe...) 主题句（例如：有几个原因可以解释为什么我认为.....）
 2. First reason (第一个原因)
 3. Example (例子)
 4. Second reason (第二个原因)
 5. Third reason (第三个原因)
- Another example (另一个结构示例):
 1. Topic sentence (e.g. Many people believe that...) 主题句（例如：许多人认为.....）
 2. Explain why (解释原因)
 3. Explain in more detail (更详细地解释)

4. Example (例子)

5. Explain why they disagree with the opposite view (解释他们为什么不同意相反的观点)

- Before you start writing it's a good idea to make some notes. Try to organise your notes according to this 5-sentence paragraph structure. 在你开始写作之前，做一些笔记是一个好主意。尝试根据这种 5 句话段落结构来组织你的笔记。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2, Questions/Advice | Permalink | Comments (33) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2，提问/建议 | 永久链接 | 评论 (33)

IELTS Writing Task 2: problem and solution (obesity)

雅思写作任务 2：问题与解决方案（儿童肥胖）

- Wednesday, September 28, 2011 2011年9月28日，星期三
- Hopefully yesterday's video gave you some good vocabulary ideas for the following question. 希望昨天的视频为以下问题提供了一些好的词汇灵感。
- Childhood obesity is becoming a serious problem in many countries. Explain the main causes and effects of this problem, and suggest some possible solutions. 儿童肥胖在许多国家正成为一个严重的问题。解释该问题的主要原因和影响，并提出一些可能的解决方案。
- Here are some more ideas for this topic: 以下是关于该话题的更多想法：
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (52) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (52)

IELTS Writing Task 2: do the advantages outweigh...?

雅思写作任务 2：“优点大于缺点吗？”题型

- Wednesday, September 21, 2011 2011年9月21日，星期三
- Some IELTS writing task 2 questions ask: "Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?" or "Do the benefits outweigh the drawbacks?" 一些雅思写作任务 2 的问题会问：“优点大于缺点吗？”或“好处大于弊端吗？”
- My advice for these questions is to write a paragraph about each side, and make it clear in the introduction and conclusion which side outweighs the other (i.e. your opinion about whether there are more advantages or disadvantages). 我对这些问题的建议是为每一方写一个段落，并在开头段和结尾段中明确哪一方大于另一方（即关于优点更多还是缺点更多的你的观点）。
- This was a recent exam question: 这是最近的一道考题：
- In some countries, governments are encouraging industries and businesses to move to regional areas outside the big cities. Do the advantages of this trend outweigh the disadvantages? 在一些国家，政府正鼓励工业和企业搬迁到大城市以外的偏远地区。这种趋势的优点大于缺点吗？
- Here are some ideas (一些想法):
 1. Introduce the topic by paraphrasing the statement, then give a clear opinion about whether there are more advantages or disadvantages. 通过改写陈述来引入主题，然后就优点更多还是缺点更多给

出明确的观点。

2. Advantages - e.g. costs are lower in regional areas; there is more space; provide jobs to boost deprived areas; avoid further overcrowding in cities. 优点 - 例如：偏远地区的成本较低；有更多的空间；提供工作机会以促进贫困地区的发展；避免城市进一步过度拥挤。
3. Disadvantages - e.g. greater availability of skilled workers in big cities; better transport and infrastructure; companies based in regional areas are further from their clients, providers and other contacts. 缺点 - 例如：大城市更有可能获得技术工人；更好的交通和基础设施；设在偏远公司的企业距离其客户、供应商和其他联系人更远。
4. Conclude by summarising your opinion in a different way. 以用不同方式总结你的观点来结束全文。

IELTS Writing Task 2: different introductions

雅思写作任务 2：不同的开头段

- Some people think the main purpose of schools is to turn children into good citizens and workers, rather than to benefit them as individuals. To what extent do you agree or disagree? 有些人认为学校的主要目的是把儿童培养成合格的公民和劳动者，而不是造福他们个人。你在多大程度上同意或不同意？
- Here are 3 different introductions. Notice that the opinion is clear in each one. 以下是 3 个不同的开头段。请注意每一个段落中的观点都是明确的。
- Agree (同意观点):
 - People have different views about what the main purpose of schools should be. 关于学校的主要目的应该是什么，人们有不同的看法。
 - Personally, I agree that a school's role is to prepare children to be productive members of society. 就个人而言，我同意学校的作用是培养儿童成为对社会有贡献的成员。
- Disagree (不同意观点):
 - Many people argue that the main role of schools is to prepare children for their future jobs. 许多人主张学校的主要作用是为儿童未来的工作做好准备。
 - However, I believe that the purpose of education should be to help children to grow as individuals. 然而，我认为教育的目的应该是帮助儿童作为个体去成长。
- Balanced view (中立平衡观点):
 - To a certain extent I agree that the role of schools is to prepare children to be productive members of society. 在某种程度上，我同意学校的作用是培养儿童成为对社会有贡献的成员。
 - However, I also believe that the education process has a positive impact on us as individuals. 然而，我也相信教育过程对我们个人有着积极的影响。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (52) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (52)

IELTS Writing Task 2: method

雅思写作任务 2：固定写作方法

- Wednesday, August 10, 2011 2011年8月10日, 星期三
- I've noticed that the more essay practice I do with my students, the more defined my writing method becomes. 我注意到, 我和学生做的文章练习越多, 我的写作方法就越清晰明确。
- For example, I now know that my 250-word essays usually contain 13 to 15 sentences: 2 for the introduction, 5 to 6 for each main paragraph and 1 sentence for the conclusion. 例如, 我现在知道我 250 字的文章通常包含 13 到 15 句话: 开头段 2 句, 每个主体段 5 到 6 句, 结尾段 1 句。
- It takes me 10 minutes to write a good plan, 5 minutes to write an introduction, I have 2 main ways of writing main paragraphs etc. etc. 我花 10 分钟写一个好的计划, 花 5 分钟写一个开头段, 我有 2 种主要的主体段写作方式等等。
- The question is: Do you have a clearly defined method? Do you repeatedly practise writing essays in the same way? 问题是: 你有一个明确定义的方法吗? 你是否反复以相同的方式练习写文章?
- If you don't have a method, it's just "hit and hope". 如果你没有方法, 那只是“碰运气/碰运气碰运气”。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (28) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (28)

IELTS Writing Task 2: advertising

雅思写作任务 2: “广告”话题

- Wednesday, August 03, 2011 2011年8月3日, 星期三
- 'Advertising' has been the topic of IELTS writing task 2 several times this year. “广告”今年已多次成为雅思写作任务 2 的话题。
- It's a popular topic, so you need some ideas and opinions about it. 这是一个热门话题, 所以你需要一些关于它的想法和观点。
- Here are some opinions about advertising, taken from my ebook. 以下是取自我的电子书的关于广告的一些观点:
 - Advertising should be **. (广告应该被****。)
 - Advertising __ children should be controlled or even banned. (__儿童 的广告应该受到控制甚至禁止。)
 - Unhealthy foods should not be marketed __ attracts children. (不健康食品不应该以__吸引儿童的方式进行营销。)
 - Products that can be a risk to health should __ warnings. (可能对健康构成风险的产品应该__警告。)
 - However, advertising is necessary in free __ economies. (然而, 广告在自由__经济中是必要的。)
 - It creates __ products. (它创造了对产品的__。)
 - Governments should only __ false information or products that are harmful. (政府应该只__虚假信息或有害产品。)
- Fill the gaps with these words/phrases: market, in a way that, regulated, display, censor, demand for, aimed at 用以下词汇/短语填空: market, in a way that, regulated, display, censor, demand for, aimed at

- Note (注意):
 - 'Advertising' is uncountable (you can't say "an advertising" or "advertisings"). 'Advertising' 是不可数名词（你不能说 "an advertising" 或 "advertisings"）。
 - 'Advertising' is the name of the industry, activity or profession (like 'marketing'). 'Advertising' 是行业、活动或职业的名称（就像 'marketing' 一样）。
 - 'An advertisement' (or 'advertisements') is what you see on TV, in the street, in newspapers etc. 'An advertisement'（或 'advertisements'）是你在电视上、街道上、报纸上等看到的内容。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (58) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 | 永久链接 | 评论 (58)

IELTS Writing Task 2: globalisation of culture

雅思写作任务 2：“文化全球化”

- Wednesday, July 27, 2011 2011年7月27日，星期三
- This was a recent exam question: 这是最近的一道考题：
- Differences between countries become less evident each year. Nowadays, all over the world people share the same fashions, advertising, brands, eating habits and TV channels. Do the disadvantages of this trend outweigh the advantages? 国家之间的差异每年都变得越来越不明显。如今，世界各地的人们共享相同的时尚、广告、品牌、饮食习惯和电视频道。这种趋势的缺点大于优点吗？
- Here's my outline for a 4-paragraph essay: 这是我写的 4 段式短文大纲：
- Introduction (开头段):
 - It is true that many aspects of culture are becoming increasingly similar throughout the world. 诚然，在世界各地，文化的许多方面正变得越来越相似。
 - Although this trend has some benefits, I would argue that there are more drawbacks. 虽然这种趋势有一些好处，但我认为缺点更多。
- First sentence of paragraph 2 (第 2 段首句):
 - On the one hand, the globalisation of fashion, brands, eating habits and other areas of culture has some benefits. (Explain the benefits) 一方面，时尚、品牌、饮食习惯和文化其他领域的全球化有一些好处。（解释好处）
- First sentence of paragraph 3 (第 3 段首句):
 - On the other hand, I believe that the disadvantages of cultural globalisation are even more significant. (Explain the disadvantages) 另一方面，我认为文化全球化的缺点更为显著。（解释缺点）
- Conclusion (结尾段):
 - In conclusion, it seems to me that the drawbacks of globalisation, in terms of cultural habits such as the clothes we wear or the foods we eat, do outweigh the benefits. 总之，在我看来，在诸如我们穿的衣服或吃的食物等文化习惯方面，全球化的缺点确实大于优点。
- Posted by Simon in IELTS Writing Task 2 | Permalink | Comments (51) 由 Simon 发布于 雅思写作任务 2 |

